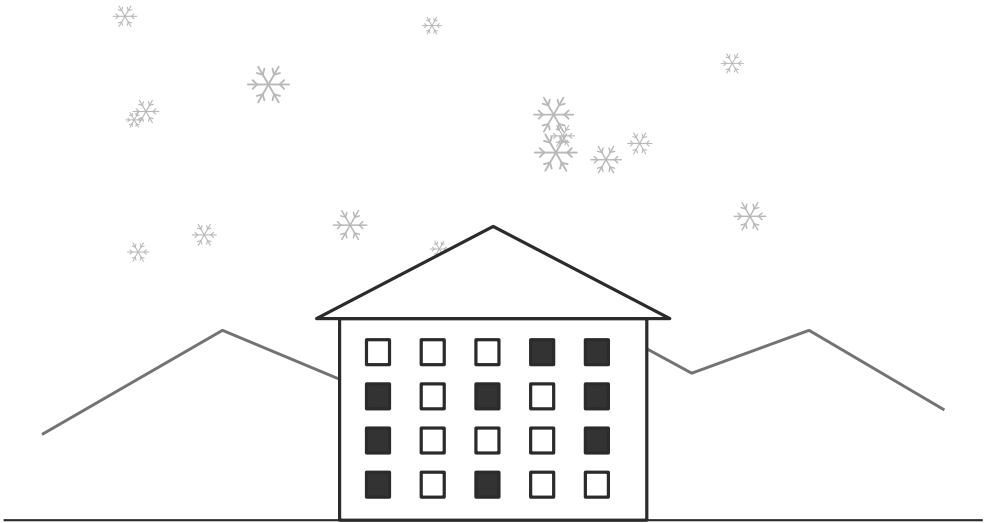


A SNOWBOUND HOTEL MYSTERY

THE THIEF STAYED THE NIGHT

*Twelve cozy cases. One snowbound week.
Can you find who did it?*



AN ELIMINATION PUZZLE BOOK

Blake La Pierre

The Thief Stayed the Night: A Snowbound Hotel Mystery

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This is a work of fiction. The Frostwood Lodge, its staff and its guests are imaginary, and any resemblance to real people or places is coincidental.

First edition, 2026

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FROSTWOOD LODGE

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WHO'S WHO

THE FROSTWOOD HOUSEHOLD



Mr. Alphonse Pemberton: Manager of the Frostwood Lodge. Round, kind, and increasingly anxious.

Pippa Pemberton: His niece, fifteen, your self-appointed assistant. Owns a magnifying glass and uses it.

Gus: The night porter. Sits at the front desk knitting a scarf that gets longer with every case.

Dot: The chambermaid. Up before everyone, notices everything, and warms the towels.

Mrs. Hilda Brisket: The cook. Guardian of the cocoa, the larder and the Bake-Off.

Miss Lettice: The librarian, who knows exactly where every book in the lodge should be.

Lady Winifred Ashgrove: Has spent every winter in the Summit Suite for forty years. Tells stories about polar bears.

Mr. Mortimer Grayle: A developer who wants to buy Frostwood and knock it down. Stays in the Tower Room.

None of these people is ever a suspect. The staff sleep in the staff cottage across the courtyard, Lady Winifred rarely leaves the Summit Suite, and Mr. Grayle, much to Mr. Pemberton's dismay, has been following him around all week and has an alibi for everything. The suspects are always guests listed in that case's register.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

HOW TO SOLVE A CASE



Every case in this book works the same way. First, read the story. It sets the scene and tells you what went missing, when, and where.

Next, study the **Register**. Every suspect in the case is listed there, along with their room, the day they arrived at the lodge, where they call home, what they do for a living, and one or two details that belong to that case alone (what they ate, what they wore, where they sat). One of them is the culprit.

Finally, work through the **Clues** in order. Each clue rules some suspects out. Cross them off the register as you go: there is a little box beside every name for exactly that purpose. Pencils are recommended; detectives change their minds. Every clue ends with a line in *italics* that states the rule exactly.

When you reach the end of the clues, exactly one name will remain. Write it on the Verdict page, then check your answer in the Solutions at the back of the book. The solutions also tell you how many suspects each clue clears, so you can find any slip.

Reading a Room Number

- * The lodge has five guest floors. The **first digit** is the floor: Room 314 is on the 3rd floor. The 1st floor is the ground floor.
- * The **last two digits** (01 to 20) tell you where the room is along its corridor. Rooms 01 to 10 are in the **West Wing**; rooms 11 to 20 are in the **East Wing**.
- * **Odd** numbers are on the **lake side** of the corridor; **even** numbers are on the **mountain side**.
- * **Across the hall**: each odd room faces the next even number (305 faces 306). **Next door**: the room two numbers away on the same side and floor (305 is next door to 303 and 307). **Directly above**: same last two digits, one floor up (405 is directly above 305).
- * Guests who share a room have the same room number. Clues about roommates, neighbours and the rooms above and below always mean

guests *listed in that case's register*, and that includes guests you have already crossed off. Crossing someone off means they are not the culprit; it does not mean they have left the lodge.

WEST WING · 01-10					EAST WING · 11-20				
Lake side (odd numbers)									
301	303	305	307	309	311	313	315	317	319
corridor					corridor				
302	304	306	308	310	312	314	316	318	320
Mountain side (even numbers)									

The 3rd floor, seen from above. Every floor is laid out the same way.

A Few House Rules

- * Everything you need is written in the book. No trick questions, no outside knowledge, no hidden codes. When a clue mentions a group of cities or jobs, it lists every one of them.
- * Clues mean exactly what they say. If a clue says a guest was elsewhere, they were.
- * Nobody gets hurt at Frostwood. The worst crimes here are pranks, pinched pastries and one very salty cake.
- * The cases get harder as the week goes on: from forty suspects and six clues on Monday to every guest in the lodge and fourteen clues on Saturday night. Each case stands alone, but the story runs through all twelve, so it is best to solve them in order.

SUNDAY

PROLOGUE



THE last bus of the afternoon ground its way up the mountain road with its windscreen wipers going like mad, and it stopped, with a sigh of relief, outside the Frostwood Lodge: five floors of creaking timber, green shutters and chimney smoke, with a little turret on top where the Summit Suite sits like a hat.

That was on Sunday. By Sunday night the snow had swallowed the road, the bus, the signpost and very nearly the postbox, and the radio in the lobby announced, with some glee, that the snowplough would reach Frostwood “by next Sunday, or thereabouts.”

The manager, Mr. Alphonse Pemberton, a round man with a round moustache, took the news bravely. He had one hundred and fifty-two guests, a larder full of cocoa, and a week of festivities planned: a snowman contest, a Bake-Off, a skating race, a Talent Evening and, on the final Sunday, a party for the lodge’s 125th birthday, beneath the portrait of its founder, Josephine Frost, which hangs in the lobby.

He also had Mr. Mortimer Grayle. Mr. Grayle builds glass-and-steel hotels with rooftop pools, and he had come up the mountain to buy Frostwood, knock it down, and put up something he calls *The SkyResort*. “You have until Sunday to sign, Pemberton,” he said, tapping a thick contract. “A charming old place, but trouble. Pure trouble. You’ll see.”

It took less than a day for trouble to arrive.

Which is where you come in. You are the guest in the little room behind the front desk, the one who finishes the newspaper crossword before the kettle boils. Mr. Pemberton’s niece, Pippa, who is fifteen and carries a detective’s notebook everywhere, noticed this within an hour of your arrival. By Monday morning she had appointed you the lodge’s Official Detective, and herself your assistant, and nobody has dared to argue.

Over the next six snowbound days there will be twelve small mysteries at Frostwood. Nobody will be hurt; that is a promise. But things will go missing, pranks will be played, a cake will be ruined and one painting will

turn out not to be what it seems. Each time, Mr. Pemberton will hand you the register, Pippa will hand you the clues, and it will be up to you to find the one guest who did it.

CASE ONE · MONDAY MORNING

THE COCOA TIN



40 suspects · 6 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

EVERY night at Frostwood ends with cocoa hour in the Great Hall, and every cup of cocoa begins with Mrs. Brisket's tin. It is a battered old thing, painted with faded edelweiss, and it holds *Brisket's Blend*: a secret mixture of cocoa and spices that Mrs. Brisket's grandmother invented and that nobody else has ever seen written down.

On Sunday night, with the snow piling up against the windows and the road gone for good, cocoa hour was especially popular. forty guests squeezed into the Great Hall. Some sat in the big chairs by the Fireside, some on the cushions by the Window, and some around the old Piano, where a guest was playing the only three tunes the piano still remembered.

At eleven o'clock, Mrs. Brisket went to the kitchen to fetch more milk. She left the tin on the serving table, between the marshmallows and the cinnamon, as she has done every night for twenty-two years.

When she came back, the tin was gone.

"Gone!" she said, so loudly that the piano stopped. "My grandmother's tin! Nobody leaves this hall until it is found!"

Unfortunately everybody had already left, because it was bedtime and Mrs. Brisket had been in the kitchen for quite a long time, looking for the good milk. By the time Mr. Pemberton arrived in his dressing gown, the Great Hall was empty except for forty dirty mugs and one very cross cook.

At breakfast on Monday, Pippa presented you with a list of every guest who had been at cocoa hour, showing where each had been sitting and what they had put on top of their cocoa. ("I wrote it down at the time," she said. "I write everything down at the time.") Mr. Grayle, eating toast at the next table, sniffed. "A missing tin of cocoa," he said. "First day of the snow. Trouble, Pemberton. I told you."

Mr. Pemberton turned pink. "You'll find it, won't you?" he whispered to you. "Mrs. Brisket won't make another cup until you do."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 40 guests who were at Sunday's cocoa hour, listed alphabetically by surname. Room numbers tell you the floor: Room 214 is on the 2nd floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Topping	Seat
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	4	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	5	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Whipped Cream	Piano
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	4	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Nothing	Piano
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Nothing	Window
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	5	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	5	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Nothing	Piano
☐ Finch, Roland	215	2	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	4	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Nothing	Window
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	4	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Marshmallows	Piano
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	2	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	4	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Whipped Cream	Window
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	2	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Cinnamon	Window
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	2	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Nothing	Window
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	3	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Nothing	Piano
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	3	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Nothing	Window
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	4	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	3	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	2	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	1	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Marshmallows	Window
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Cinnamon	Fireside
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Nothing	Window
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Nothing	Fireside
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	3	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Nothing	Piano
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	5	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Cinnamon	Piano
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Whipped Cream	Piano
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Nothing	Piano
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Marshmallows	Fireside
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Whipped Cream	Fireside
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	3	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Whipped Cream	Window
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	3	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Cinnamon	Fireside

Guest		Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Topping	Seat
☐	Yelland, Lark	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Nothing	Fireside
☐	Yelland, Queenie	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Whipped Cream	Fireside

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE FIRESIDE CHAIRS

Pippa spent the whole of cocoa hour curled up in the big armchair by the fire, reading. She is certain that nobody sitting in the Fireside chairs got up between ten and eleven, because every one of them was listening to Lady Winifred's story about the time she met a polar bear.

The thief's Seat is not Fireside.

2 EARLY TO BED

The guests who arrived on Friday had signed up for Monday's dawn snowshoe walk. At a quarter to eleven Gus marched them all into the boot room to wax their snowshoes, and he kept them there, waxing and grumbling, until well after midnight.

The thief did not arrive on Friday.

3 PLAIN COCOA

Mrs. Brisket has one firm rule: anyone who takes their cocoa with Nothing on top collects it from the kitchen hatch and never goes near the serving table, where the toppings (and the tin) were kept.

The thief's Topping is not Nothing.

4 THE LANDING

Dot was polishing the banisters on the 3rd-floor landing from eleven until midnight. Nobody went past her, up or down, and the lift had been switched off for the night. The thief carried the tin straight up to their room.

The thief's room is on the 1st or 2nd floor.

5 SNOW BACK HOME

The thief was overheard at the serving table saying, “Snow like this? We get it every winter back home.” Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these are the ones that get heavy snow every winter: Anchorage, Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Denver, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto.

The thief lives in one of these ten cities: Anchorage, Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Denver, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

6 THE STICKY SHELF

On the shelf where the tin had stood, Mrs. Brisket found a sticky, sugary thumbprint, pink and white and unmistakably marshmallow.

The thief's Topping is Marshmallows.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE COCOA TIN?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6
Left						

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE ONE

DETECTIVE'S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE TWO · MONDAY AFTERNOON

THE SNOWMAN'S HAT



48 suspects · 7 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

THE great Frostwood Snowman Contest was held in the courtyard on Monday afternoon, with the snow still falling in fat, lazy flakes. forty-eight guests took part in four teams, Red, Blue, Green and Gold, each wearing a wool armband and each quite certain it would win.

Standing over the whole contest, as he does every year, was Sir Frostington: the lodge's own snowman, seven feet tall, with coal buttons, a carrot nose and, on his head, the most precious hat in the building. It is a tall black top hat that once belonged to Mr. Pemberton's great-grandfather, Colonel Pemberton, who (so the story goes) once walked all the way down the mountain in a blizzard to fetch soup for the guests, and came back wearing the hat and not much else.

At half past three, while Mr. Pemberton was judging the Blue team's snowman, Pippa looked up and gasped. Sir Frostington's head was bare. The top hat had vanished. In its place was a licked-clean toffee-apple stick, and pinned to the snowman's scarf was a note in wobbly capitals: *SIR FROSTINGTON HAS GONE TO FETCH THE SOUP, LIKE THE COLONEL.*

"A prank!" said Mr. Pemberton faintly. "On Great-Grandpa's hat!"

Mr. Grayle, watching from the terrace with a flask of coffee, laughed until he had to sit down. "Pranks on the second day," he said. "Wait until the reviews come in."

Pippa had already begun her list. Every contestant had signed in with their team, and the food stalls around the courtyard had written down which snack each contestant had bought. (Everybody got one free snack: hot Chestnuts, a Pretzel, a Toffee Apple, or a cup of Soup.) "Forty-eight names," she said, handing it over. "And one of them is wearing a top hat under their bed."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 48 contestants in Monday's Snowman Contest, listed alphabetically by surname, with their team and the free snack each one chose. Room numbers tell you the floor: Room 214 is on the 2nd floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Team	Snack
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	1	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Green	Pretzel
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	2	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Blue	Soup
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	5	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Blue	Toffee Apple
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Green	Chestnuts
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Red	Chestnuts
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	2	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Gold	Soup
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	5	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Red	Chestnuts
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	1	Friday	Miami	Florist	Red	Pretzel
☐ Ember, Edith	503	5	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Gold	Chestnuts
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	5	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	5	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Green	Pretzel
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	5	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Gold	Toffee Apple
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	5	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Blue	Soup
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	2	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Green	Soup
☐ Gosling, Lillian	103	1	Sunday	Toronto	Painter	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	2	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Red	Chestnuts
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Red	Soup
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	1	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Blue	Chestnuts
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	Green	Chestnuts
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	1	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Blue	Chestnuts
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	3	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	3	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Blue	Chestnuts
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	3	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Gold	Toffee Apple
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	2	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Gold	Pretzel
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	4	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Green	Pretzel
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	4	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Blue	Soup
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	1	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Green	Chestnuts
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	1	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Green	Chestnuts
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Blue	Soup
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	4	Friday	Denver	Engineer	Green	Toffee Apple
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	4	Friday	Denver	Architect	Blue	Soup
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	3	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Blue	Soup
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	3	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Green	Toffee Apple
☐ Trelawney, Clara	410	4	Friday	Phoenix	Tailor	Green	Pretzel
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	3	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Gold	Chestnuts

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Team	Snack
☐ Umber, Albert	203	2	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Blue	Toffee Apple
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	2	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Gold	Chestnuts
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Gold	Soup
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Varley, Ada	512	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	Gold	Pretzel
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	Green	Toffee Apple
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	5	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Red	Toffee Apple
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	2	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Green	Soup
☐ Winterbottom, Nora	517	5	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Red	Chestnuts
☐ Young, June	407	4	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Red	Pretzel

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE JUDGING LINE

At half past three, when the hat vanished, the Blue team was standing in a neat row beside their snowman while Mr. Pemberton judged it. He says he never took his eyes off them, “because one of them kept pulling faces at me.”

The thief's Team is not Blue.

2 JUNIOR JUDGES

Every Teacher and every Student at the contest had been invited onto the junior judging panel. The panel sat together on the terrace from three o'clock until four, sipping soup and scoring noses.

The thief is not a Teacher and not a Student.

3 THE WELCOME-DINNER JOKE

The note pinned to the headless snowman read: “*Sir Frostrington has gone to fetch the soup, like the Colonel.*” That joke only makes sense if you heard Colonel Pemberton's story at Saturday night's welcome dinner. Guests who arrived on Sunday missed the dinner.

The thief arrived on Friday or Saturday.

4 THE EAST DOOR

Pippa followed a line of footprints from the snowman to the East Door. The East Door opens only onto the East Wing stairs, and Gus saw the thief climb them. On every floor, the East Wing holds the rooms whose last two digits are 11 to 20 (for example, 311 to 320).

The thief's room number ends in 11 to 20.

5 SNOWMEN BACK HOME

The thief had bragged, “Where I come from, snowmen twice this size are built every winter, and the snow lasts until spring.” Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, only these have snow that lasts all winter long: Anchorage, Buffalo, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto.

The thief lives in Anchorage, Buffalo, Minneapolis, Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

6 THE DROPPED MITTEN

Beside the snowman lay a mitten with a name tape sewn inside. The ink had run in the wet snow, but the first letter of the surname was clearly from the first part of the alphabet, somewhere from **A** to **L**.

The thief's surname begins with a letter from A to L.

7 THE TOFFEE STICK

Where the top hat had been, the thief had left a toffee-apple stick, licked perfectly clean. The toffee-apple stall sold its apples only to contestants, one each, and wrote the name of every buyer in the Snack column.

The thief's Snack is Toffee Apple.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE SNOWMAN’S HAT?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Left							

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I’M SURE:

CASE TWO

DETECTIVE'S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

THE STARLIGHT SAPPHIRE



60 suspects · 8 clues · Difficulty ❄❄❄❄❄

THE most distinguished guest at Frostwood is Lady Winifred Ashgrove, who occupies the Summit Suite at the very top of the lodge, a few steps above the 5th floor. Lady Winifred has come to Frostwood every winter for forty years, and every year she brings the *Starlight Sapphire*: a necklace of pale blue stones that, when held up to the chandelier, scatters little stars across the walls. She had shown it off at the welcome dinner on Saturday evening, and more than a few guests had gasped.

On Monday night Lady Winifred placed the necklace, as always, in the velvet box on her dressing table, drank her warm milk, and went to sleep with the wind howling outside.

At seven o'clock on Tuesday morning her shriek could be heard in the boiler room.

The velvet box was open. The necklace was gone.

Mr. Pemberton arrived in his dressing gown and slippers, followed closely by half the 5th floor. There was no sign of a break-in. The window was latched and frosted shut, and outside it lay a smooth, unbroken drift of snow. Whoever had taken the *Starlight Sapphire* had walked in through the door, and whoever it was had not left the lodge, because nobody *could* leave the lodge.

"It must be one of the guests," Mr. Pemberton whispered, clutching the register to his chest as though it might be stolen next.

It was not quite as bad as it sounded. The Summit Suite can only be reached through the Old Wing staircases, and on Monday night the door between the Old Wing and the rest of the lodge had been bolted by Gus at ten o'clock sharp, as it is every night. That left the sixty guests whose rooms were on the Old Wing side of that door. One of them was sleeping with a sapphire necklace tucked under their pillow.

By breakfast the lodge was buzzing. Gus remembered a few things. Dot remembered a few more. Lady Winifred herself had a story. Little by little,

Pippa gathered the clues together and laid them out in front of the fire. Mr. Grayle said it was “the final straw, surely,” and asked Mr. Pemberton whether he had a pen.

Mr. Pemberton turned to you. “Please,” he said. “Before the snowplough comes and the thief rides off down the mountain with it.”

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 60 guests who were on the Old Wing side of the bolted door on Monday night, listed alphabetically by surname. Room numbers tell you the floor: Room 214 is on the 2nd floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	5	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor
☐ Birch, Felix	117	1	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Student
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	4	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	2	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	2	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	5	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	3	Saturday	Anchorage	Student
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	3	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	3	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	5	Saturday	Denver	Photographer
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	1	Saturday	Miami	Doctor
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	1	Saturday	Miami	Tailor
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	5	Friday	Denver	Novelist
☐ Finch, Roland	215	2	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	2	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	3	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor
☐ Gosling, Lillian	103	1	Sunday	Toronto	Painter
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	3	Friday	Denver	Violinist
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	3	Friday	Denver	Botanist
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	5	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	2	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	5	Saturday	Denver	Pilot
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	1	Friday	Denver	Librarian
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	1	Friday	Denver	Nurse
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	1	Friday	Denver	Student
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	3	Sunday	San Diego	Baker
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	5	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	3	Saturday	Montreal	Baker
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	4	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	2	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	4	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	4	Friday	San Diego	Librarian
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	4	Friday	San Diego	Florist
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	2	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	2	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	4	Sunday	Toronto	Architect

Guest	Room	Floor	Arrived	Home City	Occupation
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	5	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	5	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	4	Friday	Denver	Engineer
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	4	Friday	Denver	Architect
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	5	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	4	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	5	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	5	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	3	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	4	Friday	Chicago	Chef
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	2	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	2	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Nurse
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	4	Friday	San Diego	Florist
☐ Winterbottom, Nora	517	5	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	2	Sunday	Toronto	Architect
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	2	Sunday	Toronto	Student
☐ Wren, Olive	209	2	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist
☐ Yelland, Lark	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor
☐ Yelland, Queenie	114	1	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor
☐ Zeller, Toby	402	4	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE BACK STAIRS

Gus the night porter sat at the front desk in the lobby all night long, knitting his very long scarf. He swears that nobody walked through the lobby or used the lift after midnight. The only other way up to the Summit Suite is the narrow back staircase, which begins on the 2nd-floor landing. Guests with rooms on the 1st (ground) floor could not have reached it without passing Gus.

The thief is not staying on the 1st floor.

2 THE WELCOME DINNER

Lady Winifred tells people where she keeps the necklace at night only once a year: at the welcome dinner, which was held on Saturday evening. She announced it rather loudly over the soup. Guests who arrived on Sunday missed the dinner entirely and had no idea where to look.

The thief arrived on Friday or Saturday.

3 THE MIDNIGHT HICCUPS

At half past one, a guest in the library came down with a spectacular case of the hiccups. Every Doctor and every Nurse staying at the lodge hurried to the library and stayed there until well after three, arguing cheerfully about the best cure.

The thief is not a Doctor and not a Nurse.

4 BORROWED BOOTS

On Sunday evening, a guest came to the front desk to borrow a pair of snow boots, admitting that they had “never seen real snow before in my whole life.” Dot found those very boots, still damp, outside the Summit Suite. Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, the ones where it practically never snows are Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego and Tampa.

The thief lives in Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego or Tampa.

5 THE CLICKING DOOR

Dot the chambermaid was up early warming the towels. Just after two, she heard a door on the mountain side of a corridor click softly shut. On every floor of the lodge, the rooms on the mountain side have even numbers.

The thief's room number is even.

6 THE MONOGRAM

Caught on a nail at the top of the back stairs was a scrap of a handkerchief, embroidered with the tail end of a letter. It was the initial of the thief's surname, and it could only have been a letter from the second half of the alphabet: N to Z.

The thief's surname begins with a letter from N to Z.

7 OUT OF BREATH

The last clue comes from Lady Winifred herself. She half-woke in the night and heard someone outside her door, panting and puffing "as though they had just climbed a mountain." The Summit Suite sits just a few steps above the 5th floor, so a guest from the 5th floor would not have been out of breath at all.

The thief is not staying on the 5th floor.

8 NOBODY TO VOUCH

Everyone who shared a room was woken by the wind at about two o'clock, the time of the theft, and each can vouch that their roommates were right there, grumbling about the draught. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief is staying in a room alone.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE SAPPHIRE?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Left								

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE THREE

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

THE SALTED SPONGE



64 suspects · 8 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

THE Great Frostwood Bake-Off is the most serious event of the week. On Tuesday afternoon the Great Hall was filled with four long rows of baking stations, labelled A, B, C and D, and sixty-four contestants in borrowed aprons, each baking one entry: a Sponge, a Tart, Scones, Shortbread, or a Pie.

The favourite, to everyone's surprise, was Mr. Grayle. He had announced at lunch that he had won a baking prize at school "and several since," and that his lemon sponge was "unbeatable." He had also announced, rather loudly, that he planned to make "a little speech about the future of this building" when he collected his trophy.

At twenty past two, something happened in the west pantry. Nobody saw it. But at three o'clock, when the judges took their first forkful of Mr. Grayle's lemon sponge, their faces went through several interesting shapes. The sponge was salty. Extremely salty. Somebody had swapped the sugar jar in the west pantry for the salt jar, and Mr. Grayle, who had been bustling about with his measuring cups, had used a whole cupful.

"Sabotage!" cried Mr. Grayle, red to the ears. "This place is a madhouse, Pemberton! A madhouse!"

Mrs. Brisket tasted the sponge herself and agreed it was sabotage, and also that it was "a very light texture, considering." The sugar jar was nowhere to be found.

Pippa had written down every contestant's station and entry, of course, and she had been hiding behind a sack of flour for most of the afternoon, "for observation purposes." Between her notes and the gossip at the judges' table, you soon had a stack of clues. There was only one question left: which of the sixty-four bakers had done it?

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 64 contestants in Tuesday's Bake-Off, listed alphabetically by surname, with their Entry and their baking Station. Room numbers tell you the floor: Room 214 is on the 2nd floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Entry	Station
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Pie	C
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Sponge	A
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	Pie	D
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Tart	A
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Scones	C
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Scones	B
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse	Scones	D
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	Pie	C
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Pie	B
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Tart	B
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Sponge	C
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Shortbread	C
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Pie	D
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Pie	D
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	Scones	B
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Scones	A
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Pie	A
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Shortbread	D
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Tart	D
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Scones	D
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Tart	C
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Tart	D
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Pie	D
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Shortbread	B
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Shortbread	B
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	Sponge	C
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Pie	B
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Shortbread	A
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Sponge	A
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Pie	B
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Sponge	C
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Scones	B
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Pie	C
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Sponge	D
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Tart	A
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Pie	A
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Scones	A
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	Shortbread	B

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Entry	Station
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Scones	D
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Tart	C
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Scones	C
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Scones	B
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Tart	A
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Pie	B
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Shortbread	C
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Sponge	D
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	Scones	C
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Sponge	C
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Sponge	C
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Sponge	C
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Sponge	C
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Sponge	B
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Scones	A
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Tart	D
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Pie	A
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Tart	B
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Pie	A
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Scones	D
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Tart	A
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Tart	D
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Shortbread	A
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Pie	B
☐ Young, June	407	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Sponge	B
☐ Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Tart	C

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE WEST PANTRY

The salt and sugar were swapped in the west pantry. Contestants at Stations A and B fetched their ingredients from the east pantry at the other end of the hall, and Mrs. Brisket, who stood guard there, says not one of them wandered.

The thief's Station is C or D.

2 THE JUDGES' TABLE

Every Chef and every Baker staying at the lodge had been asked to help judge, and they sat together on the stage for the whole contest, where everybody could see them.

The thief is not a Chef and not a Baker.

3 IN THE OVEN

The swap happened at twenty past two. At exactly that moment, everyone baking Scones or Pie was kneeling in front of the ovens, watching their entries rise, because the ovens at Frostwood are famous for their tempers.

The thief's Entry is not Scones and not Pie.

4 THE LIFT INDICATOR

Just after the swap, the thief slipped out and took the lift upstairs to hide the sugar. Gus watched the brass arrow above the lift doors: it stopped at the 3rd floor and at the 4th floor, and nowhere else, before coming back down empty.

The thief's room is on the 3rd or 4th floor.

5 A WHISPERED WORD

Pippa, hiding behind a flour sack, heard the thief mutter, "Wait until I tell my roommate about this." (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief shares a room with at least one other guest.

6 THE APRON

An apron was left crumpled in the west pantry, embroidered with a single initial: the first letter of the thief's first name. The embroidery was worn, but it was certainly a letter from **A** to **M**.

The thief's first name begins with a letter from A to M.

7 SEA SALT

Tasting the ruined sponge, the thief was heard to say, "That's nothing like the sea salt we get at home, right by the ocean." Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these are the ones beside the sea: Anchorage, Boston, Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, San Diego and Tampa.

The thief lives in Anchorage, Boston, Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, San Diego or Tampa.

8 CINNAMON SUGAR

The lid of the sugar jar was dusted with cinnamon sugar. Only two recipes in the whole contest used cinnamon sugar: the Tart and the Shortbread.

The thief's Entry is Tart or Shortbread.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO SALTED THE SPONGE?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Left								

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE FOUR

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

THE MISSING FIRST EDITION



72 suspects · 9 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

THE Frostwood library occupies a long, low room on the 2nd floor of the West Wing, with a crackling fire, three sleeping cats and a very good view of the snow. Its greatest treasure is a first edition of *The Mystery at Pinecrest Pass*, the famous detective novel that was written, so they say, in this very room, in a single snowbound winter many years ago.

On Tuesday, Miss Lettice the librarian moved the book from its old oak shelf into a new glass case, to keep it safe from sticky fingers. At lunchtime she locked the case, polished the glass and stood back admiring it.

On Wednesday morning the case was empty.

The cuckoo clock above the fireplace had been nudged and had stopped at a quarter past eleven, which was a great help. So was the library visitors' book, which Miss Lettice insists every visitor signs. On Tuesday seventy-two guests had signed it, each one noting when they visited (Morning, Afternoon or Evening) and which kind of book they borrowed: Mystery, Poetry, Travel, Cookery or Science.

"Somebody on this list," Miss Lettice said, tapping the visitors' book, "has taken the most valuable book in the lodge. And I want it back before breakfast tomorrow, or I shall close the library." The whole lodge gasped. On a snowbound mountain, a closed library is a very serious threat.

Mr. Grayle, passing, remarked that in *his* hotels there would be no libraries at all, "just screens, and far less trouble." Miss Lettice looked at him in a way that made the cats leave the room.

Pippa had spent the morning interviewing everyone in sight. "I've got nine clues," she told you, "and a very strong feeling."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 72 guests who signed the library visitors' book on Tuesday, listed alphabetically by surname, with the kind of book each Borrowed and when each Visited. The first digit of a room number is the floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Borrowed	Visited
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	Science	Morning
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Cookery	Evening
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Travel	Evening
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Cookery	Evening
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Cookery	Morning
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Mystery	Morning
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Science	Morning
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Poetry	Morning
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Science	Morning
☐ Frost, Gracie	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Mystery	Morning
☐ Frost, Monty	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Pilot	Travel	Evening
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Science	Morning
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Cookery	Morning
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Travel	Afternoon
☐ Honeycutt, Bertram	320	Sunday	Anchorage	Florist	Science	Evening
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Science	Afternoon
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Cookery	Afternoon
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	Poetry	Morning
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Science	Afternoon
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Travel	Morning
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Science	Morning
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Travel	Evening
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Science	Afternoon
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Mystery	Morning
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Cookery	Evening
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Cookery	Evening
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Travel	Evening
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Travel	Morning
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Travel	Morning
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Mystery	Morning
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Cookery	Evening
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	Science	Morning
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	Science	Morning
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Travel	Afternoon
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Science	Morning

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Borrowed	Visited
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Science	Morning
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	Friday	Denver	Engineer	Travel	Morning
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	Friday	Denver	Architect	Cookery	Morning
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	Mystery	Morning
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Mystery	Morning
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Science	Afternoon
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	Cookery	Evening
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Poetry	Afternoon
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	Cookery	Evening
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Mystery	Morning
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	Science	Evening
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	Travel	Evening
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	Science	Evening
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Poetry	Evening
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Travel	Afternoon
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Science	Afternoon
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Science	Afternoon
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Poetry	Afternoon
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Science	Evening
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Poetry	Evening
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	Mystery	Evening
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	Cookery	Morning
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Science	Afternoon
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Science	Evening
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Travel	Evening
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Travel	Afternoon
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Science	Afternoon
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Mystery	Morning
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Mystery	Afternoon
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Travel	Morning
☐ Young, June	407	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Poetry	Evening

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE POETRY CIRCLE

The library's cuckoo clock was nudged and stopped at 11:15 p.m. as the book was lifted from its case. At that moment every guest who had borrowed a Poetry book was in the conservatory at the Poetry Circle, reading aloud by candle-lantern.

The thief's Borrowed book is not Poetry.

2 THE LATE JAM SESSION

Also at 11:15 p.m., every Violinist, Painter and Photographer at the lodge was in the Music Room for an impromptu jam session. The Photographers were taking pictures; the Painters were mostly tapping on biscuit tins.

The thief is not a Violinist, a Painter or a Photographer.

3 THE WEST STAIRS

The library sits in the West Wing, and Dot found a bookmark from the book on the West Wing stairs. Gus has confirmed the thief used them to go straight to their room. The West Wing holds the rooms whose last two digits are 01 to 10 on every floor (for example, 401 to 410).

The thief's room number ends in 01 to 10.

4 TWO TEACUPS

The next morning, Dot collected a tray from outside the thief's door. On it were exactly two teacups, two saucers, and the lodge's rule is one cup per guest in the room. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief's room holds exactly two guests.

5 A LIBRARY CARD

The thief used a library card to prop open the glass case, and left it behind by mistake. Friday arrivals were given blue library cards; everyone else got green ones. The card left behind was green.

The thief did not arrive on Friday.

6 THE AUTHOR'S TOUR

When the book first came out, its author toured six cities to sign copies. The thief told Pippa, "I met the author when the tour came to my home town." The six tour cities were Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto.

The thief lives in Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

7 AFTER LUNCH

The book was only moved into its glass case at lunchtime on Tuesday. Guests who visited the library in the Morning saw it on the old oak shelf, and would have gone looking there.

The thief Visited in the Afternoon or the Evening.

8 THE PRESSED FLOWER

Tucked inside the glass case was a pressed sprig of edelweiss that had fallen out of the thief's own library book. Miss Lettice, the librarian, knows her shelves: only the Travel and Mystery books have pressed flowers for bookmarks.

The thief's Borrowed book is Travel or Mystery.

9 THE SIGNATURE

In the visitors' book, the thief's surname had been hastily scribbled out, but Pippa counted the humps and loops with a magnifying glass. The surname had more than six letters.

The thief's surname has seven or more letters.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE FIRST EDITION?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Left									

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE FIVE

DETECTIVE'S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE SIX · WEDNESDAY AFTERNOON

THE TANGLED LACES



80 suspects · 9 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

BY Wednesday the lake behind the lodge had frozen as smooth as glass, and Mr. Pemberton declared that the Frostwood Skating Race would take place at four o'clock. eighty guests signed up, and the race marshal (Gus, in a borrowed whistle) divided them into four heats: Heat 1, Heat 2, Heat 3 and Heat 4. Everybody was given a team scarf, too, which made the start line look like a box of crayons.

The lodge keeps its rental skates in a little wooden shed at the edge of the lake. At three o'clock Pippa went to fetch them and found every single pair of skates sitting neatly on its shelf, and not one single lace. All eighty laces were gone.

They turned up twenty minutes later, hanging from the roof of the lakeside gazebo: knotted together into one enormous, tangled ball the size of a pumpkin, like some sort of woollen hedgehog.

It took Mrs. Brisket, Dot and three volunteers with knitting needles almost an hour to untangle them, and the race began very late, in the dusk, with lanterns on the ice. Mr. Grayle, who had been timing the delay on his expensive watch, told everyone that at The SkyResort the ice rink would be indoors, heated and "completely lace-free." Nobody knew what that meant.

Pippa had the race sign-up sheet, showing everyone's heat and scarf, and she had spent the hour of untangling asking questions. "It wasn't an accident," she said. "Nobody ties eighty laces together by accident."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 80 guests who signed up for the Skating Race, listed alphabetically by surname, with their Heat and team Scarf. The first digit of a room number is the floor. Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Heat	Scarf
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	1	Green
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	3	Striped
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	4	Striped
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	3	Red
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	1	Blue
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse	2	Blue
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	4	Blue
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	1	Green
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	3	Blue
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	1	Blue
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	Saturday	Miami	Doctor	1	Blue
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	Saturday	Miami	Tailor	3	Blue
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	4	Green
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	3	Green
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	4	Blue
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	1	Striped
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	4	Blue
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	4	Striped
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	1	Striped
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	4	Striped
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	2	Green
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	2	Green
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	1	Red
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	1	Green
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	4	Green
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	3	Red
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	2	Green
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	4	Green
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	3	Blue
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	1	Red
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	4	Striped
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	3	Green
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	4	Green
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	3	Green
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	2	Striped
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	3	Blue
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	2	Blue
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	1	Red

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Heat	Scarf
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	3	Green
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	1	Blue
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	1	Red
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	1	Green
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	1	Blue
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	1	Blue
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	4	Striped
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	1	Green
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	1	Green
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	3	Green
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	2	Red
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	3	Blue
☐ Quill, Alma	408	Saturday	Los Angeles	Pilot	1	Red
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	4	Blue
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	2	Striped
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	1	Striped
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	2	Striped
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	2	Blue
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	2	Blue
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	1	Blue
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	1	Striped
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	4	Green
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	4	Blue
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	1	Blue
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer	3	Blue
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer	3	Striped
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	1	Red
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	4	Red
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	4	Striped
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	1	Striped
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	4	Green
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	1	Blue
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	1	Green
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	3	Green
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	Friday	San Diego	Florist	2	Green
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	2	Red
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	4	Red
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	1	Blue
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	2	Green
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	3	Red
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	2	Green
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	1	Striped

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 WARMING UP

At three o'clock, when the laces vanished, the skaters in Heat 1 were already out on the ice warming up, going round and round under the eye of the race marshal.

The thief's Heat is not 1.

2 THE FIRST-AID TENT

Every Doctor, Nurse and Dentist at the lodge was running the first-aid tent beside the lake, which mostly meant handing out blankets and hot cocoa. They stayed there together all afternoon.

The thief is not a Doctor, a Nurse or a Dentist.

3 THE LAKE VIEW

The skate shed can only be seen from the lake side of the lodge. The thief waited at their bedroom window until the coast was clear. On every floor, the rooms on the lake side have odd numbers.

The thief's room number is odd.

4 WHERE'S THE SHED?

At lunchtime, the thief asked Gus where the skate shed was. Anyone who arrived on Friday or Saturday had been shown the shed on Saturday's lakeside walk, and would not have needed to ask.

The thief arrived on Sunday.

5 FROZEN PONDS

The knot was tied in the style of a pond-hockey net, and the thief admitted to Pippa, “We skate on the frozen lakes back home every winter.” Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these have frozen lakes or ponds for skating every winter: Anchorage, Buffalo, Chicago, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal and Toronto.

The thief lives in Anchorage, Buffalo, Chicago, Milwaukee, Minneapolis, Montreal or Toronto.

6 THE HOT-WATER BOTTLES

Between a quarter to three and a quarter past, Dot delivered hot-water bottles to every guest on the 4th and 5th floors, and every one of them answered the door in person, wrapped in a blanket.

The thief's room is on the 1st, 2nd or 3rd floor.

7 GREEN FLUFF

Picked out of the knot of laces with tweezers: several strands of green wool. Only Green scarves and Striped scarves (which are green and white) have green wool in them.

The thief's Scarf is Green or Striped.

8 THE SIGN-UP SHEET

The thief crossed their own name off the sign-up sheet in a fit of guilt, but the sheet is in alphabetical order, and the crossed-out line falls in the section for surnames beginning **A** to **M**.

The thief's surname begins with a letter from A to M.

9 SAY CHEESE

From ten to three until ten past, the skaters in Heat 2 were lined up by the boathouse having their team photograph taken. It took twenty minutes because somebody kept blinking.

The thief's Heat is not 2.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE LACES?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Left									

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE SIX

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE SEVEN · THURSDAY MORNING

THE MIDNIGHT FEAST



90 suspects · 10 clues · Difficulty ❄❄❄❄❄

ON Wednesday evening Mrs. Brisket baked sixty sticky cinnamon buns for Thursday's festival breakfast. She glazed them, set them out on her largest tray in the cold larder, locked the larder door with her own key, and went to bed feeling that all was right with the world.

At six o'clock on Thursday morning, the larder door was locked and the tray was empty. Not a bun remained. There were crumbs, a smear of glaze on the door handle, and a trail of pastry flakes leading out across the kitchen and up the West Wing stairs.

"Sixty buns," said Mrs. Brisket, in a voice like a very distant avalanche. "Sixty."

Gus had been awake all night at the front desk, knitting, and he had seen somebody in pyjamas slip past the end of the corridor at one in the morning. Dot had noticed some slipper-marks. And Pippa, who takes these things personally, had spent the morning going door to door with a clipboard, asking ninety sleepy guests what pyjamas and slippers they had been wearing the night before. (Most of them told her. Some of them told her rather more than she needed to know.)

Mr. Grayle came down to a breakfast of dry toast. "Burglary," he said, "in the kitchens. Honestly, Pemberton, how much longer can you keep this up?" Mr. Pemberton pretended not to hear, and ate his toast in silence.

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 90 guests who could have reached the kitchen on Wednesday night, listed alphabetically by surname, with the Pyjamas and Slippers they wore. The first digit of a room number is the floor.

Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Pyjamas	Slippers
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Plain	Moccasin
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Plaid	Moccasin
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse	Spotted	None
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Spotted	None
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Striped	Bunny
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	Spotted	Moccasin
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	Striped	Bunny
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Plaid	None
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	Striped	None
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	Plaid	None
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Plain	None
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Striped	Woolly
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Spotted	Moccasin
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Plaid	Moccasin
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Plain	Moccasin
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Plaid	None
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	Striped	Bunny
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Striped	Bunny
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Plain	None
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Plaid	None
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Plaid	Bunny
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Plaid	Moccasin
☐ Jarvis, Gertie	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Chef	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Jarvis, Vivian	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Plain	Moccasin
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Plain	None
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Spotted	Woolly

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Pyjamas	Slippers
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Spotted	None
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Spotted	None
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Plaid	None
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Striped	Woolly
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Plaid	Bunny
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Plain	Moccasin
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Striped	Woolly
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Plaid	Moccasin
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	Striped	Moccasin
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	Striped	None
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Spotted	None
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Plaid	None
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Plaid	Bunny
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	Plaid	None
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Striped	Bunny
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Plaid	Bunny
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Spotted	None
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	Plain	Woolly
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	Plain	None
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Spotted	Moccasin
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Plain	None
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Striped	None
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Plain	None
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Plain	None
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	Plain	Woolly
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Plain	Bunny
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer	Plain	Moccasin
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Striped	Bunny
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Plain	None
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Plaid	Moccasin
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Spotted	Bunny
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Plain	None
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Spotted	Woolly
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Plain	None
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Plaid	Woolly
☐ Whitlock, Ivy	211	Sunday	Quebec City	Doctor	Striped	Bunny
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Spotted	Woolly

	Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Pyjamas	Slippers
☐	Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Spotted	Bunny
☐	Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Spotted	Moccasin
☐	Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Plaid	Bunny
☐	Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Plaid	Moccasin
☐	Young, June	407	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Plain	Bunny
☐	Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Plaid	None

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THE CRUMB TRAIL

A trail of pastry crumbs led from the cold larder to the West Wing stairs, and Dot followed it all the way up to the thief's floor. The West Wing holds the rooms whose last two digits are 01 to 10 (for example, 201 to 210).

The thief's room number ends in 01 to 10.

2 GUS'S GLIMPSE

At one in the morning Gus caught a glimpse of the thief's back disappearing round a corner. He couldn't see a face, but the pyjamas were definitely lined: either Striped or Plaid. (Spotted and Plain pyjamas have no lines.)

The thief's Pyjamas are Striped or Plaid.

3 THE COLD STONE FLOOR

The larder floor is solid stone and freezing cold. Mrs. Brisket found no bare footprints, only the soft scuffs of slippers.

The thief's Slippers are not None.

4 THE MIDNIGHT MOVIE

Every Student at the lodge was at the midnight movie in the games room, chaperoned by every Teacher at the lodge. The film was three hours long and very loud, and nobody left before two.

The thief is not a Student and not a Teacher.

5 NOT THE GROUND FLOOR

Gus's desk looks straight down the 1st-floor corridor. He is sure no 1st-floor door opened all night.

The thief is not staying on the 1st floor.

6 THE POSTCARD

Among the crumbs was a half-written postcard: “Dear Mum, the pastries in the United States are...” Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, the Canadian ones are Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto; all the others are in the United States.

The thief does not live in Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

7 THE SQUEAKY BOARD

The third board inside the larder door squeaks loudly under anything hard-soled, and Moccasins are hard-soled. It did not squeak all night: Mrs. Brisket’s cat sleeps beside it and would have woken up. Only Woolly and Bunny slippers are soft enough to cross it silently.

The thief’s Slippers are Woolly or Bunny.

8 PLAID OR BUNNY

The cat’s whiskers had caught one tuft of fluff, and Mrs. Brisket, who knows her fabrics, says it came either from Plaid pyjamas or from Bunny slippers. Gus, who saw the thief’s back, is equally sure the thief was not wearing both at once: “Plaid with bunnies? I’d have remembered that.”

Exactly one is true: the thief’s Pyjamas are Plaid, or the thief’s Slippers are Bunny. (Not both, not neither.)

9 THE DOOR NUMBER

The last crumb lay outside a door on the mountain side of the corridor. On every floor, the rooms on the mountain side have even numbers.

The thief’s room number is even.

10 THE BORROWED KEY

The larder was locked, and the thief opened it with a key. On Sunday, Mrs. Brisket gave a spare larder key to every Chef and every Baker in the lodge, for the Bake-Off. The thief must have borrowed one from a roommate. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

Someone else in the thief’s room is a Chef or a Baker.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO ATE THE FEAST?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Left										

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE SEVEN

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE EIGHT · THURSDAY AFTERNOON

THE SNOW GLOBE



100 suspects · 10 clues · Difficulty ❄️❄️❄️❄️

ON the lobby mantelpiece, for as long as anyone can remember, has stood the Frostwood snow globe: a heavy glass dome on a carved walnut base, and inside it a tiny model of the lodge itself, complete with green shutters and a little turret. Shake it and the snow falls on the tiny roof just as it falls on the real one. For most of the lodge's history it lived in the dining room, and it was only moved to the lobby at lunchtime on Saturday, to make room for the Bake-Off trophy.

On Thursday afternoon the lobby was quiet. Most guests were out enjoying the snow, or warming up in the sauna, or playing cards, or asleep in the library with a book on their face. At four o'clock, Gus came back to his desk from a tea break and looked at the mantelpiece, and the mantelpiece was bare.

"It's just a snow globe," said Mr. Grayle, who happened to be reading a newspaper in the corner. But he said it rather more quietly than usual, and later Pippa saw him standing by the empty mantelpiece, looking thoughtful.

Pippa had already made a list of all the one hundred guests who had not been locked out of the lobby that afternoon (the side door had been bolted for painting), and next to each name she wrote down what they had been doing at three o'clock and what coat they had been wearing. "Lots of coats," she said, "and one of them had a snow globe hidden under it."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 100 guests who could have passed through the lobby on Thursday afternoon, listed alphabetically by surname, with what each was doing At 3 p.m. and the Coat each wore. The first digit of a room number is the floor; the last two digits tell you where the room is on its corridor (see How to Solve a Case). Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 3 p.m.	Coat
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Sledding	Cape
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Cards	Duffle
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Skating	Fleece
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Snowshoeing	Parka
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Cards	Parka
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Skating	Duffle
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Cards	Duffle
☐ Cheeseman, Piers	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Cheeseman, Violet	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Baker	Sauna	Parka
☐ Cheeseman, Winnie	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Cards	Duffle
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	Skating	Cape
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	Library	Duffle
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Sauna	Fleece
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Cards	Duffle
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Snowshoeing	Duffle
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Snowshoeing	Duffle
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	Saturday	Miami	Doctor	Sauna	Cape
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	Saturday	Miami	Tailor	Sledding	Parka
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Skating	Duffle
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Sledding	Parka
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Sauna	Cape
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Skating	Cape
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	Cards	Parka
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Library	Cape
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Library	Duffle
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Snowshoeing	Cape
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Cards	Duffle
☐ Frost, Gracie	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Snowshoeing	Parka
☐ Frost, Monty	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Pilot	Sauna	Duffle
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Library	Parka
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	Sauna	Fleece
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Sauna	Cape
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Sauna	Fleece
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Snowshoeing	Cape
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	Library	Duffle

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 3 p.m.	Coat
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Honeycutt, Bertram	320	Sunday	Anchorage	Florist	Cards	Fleece
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Library	Cape
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Sauna	Duffle
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	Sledding	Fleece
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	Cards	Cape
☐ Ivers, Gideon	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Teacher	Cards	Cape
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	Sauna	Parka
☐ Jarvis, Gertie	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Chef	Snowshoeing	Duffle
☐ Jarvis, Vivian	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Cards	Parka
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Sledding	Parka
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Sledding	Duffle
☐ Knightley, Silas	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	Saturday	Denver	Pilot	Sauna	Duffle
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Cards	Parka
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Sauna	Parka
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Sauna	Duffle
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Sledding	Duffle
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Sledding	Fleece
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Cards	Fleece
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Sauna	Parka
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Snowshoeing	Duffle
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Cards	Duffle
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Skating	Cape
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Library	Fleece
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Library	Fleece
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Cards	Parka
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Skating	Duffle
☐ Quill, Alma	408	Saturday	Los Angeles	Pilot	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Sauna	Cape
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	Library	Cape
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Sledding	Parka
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	Sledding	Duffle
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Sledding	Cape
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	Cards	Cape
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	Snowshoeing	Parka
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	Skating	Parka
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Sledding	Duffle
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Sauna	Cape
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Cards	Duffle

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 3 p.m.	Coat
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Snowshoeing	Duffle
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Skating	Fleece
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Library	Fleece
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Skating	Fleece
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Skating	Cape
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Sledding	Duffle
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	Library	Duffle
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	Sauna	Cape
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Library	Fleece
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Library	Fleece
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Snowshoeing	Fleece
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Cards	Duffle
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Cards	Cape
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Skating	Parka
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Skating	Parka
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Skating	Fleece
☐ Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Skating	Parka

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 SNOW ON THE CARPET

Under the lobby mantel where the snow globe had stood, Pippa found a little puddle of melted snow. The thief had come in from outdoors. The outdoor activities at 3 p.m. were Skating, Sledding and Snowshoeing.

The thief was Skating, Sledding or Snowshoeing at 3 p.m.

2 THE CLOAKROOM

Capes are not allowed on the sledding hill or the lake, so every Cape was hung up in the cloakroom at two o'clock, and Gus locked the door until five. No guest wearing a Cape could have been outdoors.

The thief's Coat is not Cape.

3 THE GRAND STAIRCASE

The globe is heavy, so the thief carried it up the Grand Staircase rather than risk the creaky lift. Dot was on the 2nd-floor landing and saw somebody hurry past her with a bulging coat, heading further up.

The thief's room is on the 3rd, 4th or 5th floor.

4 THE INTERVIEW

From three until four, every Photographer, Journalist and Novelist at the lodge was up in the Summit Suite interviewing Lady Winifred for a magazine article about her polar bear.

The thief is not a Photographer, a Journalist or a Novelist.

5 ACROSS THE HALL

When the thief's door clicked shut, the door directly across the hall opened, and a guest peeped out and called, "Did you hear that?" (Across the hall means the facing room: every odd-numbered room faces the next even number, so 305 faces 306 and 419 faces 420.)

The room directly across the hall from the thief's room has at least one guest listed on this register.

6 THE DINING ROOM

Until Saturday lunchtime, the snow globe lived in the dining room. Friday arrivals had only ever seen it there, and they all still think it's there; Pippa asked every one of them.

The thief did not arrive on Friday.

7 EASTERN TIME

The thief's wristwatch left a print in the dust on the mantel, and Pippa noticed the thief checking it: it was still set to Eastern Time, the time back home. Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these are on Eastern Time: Boston, Buffalo, Miami, Montreal, Quebec City, Tampa and Toronto.

The thief lives in Boston, Buffalo, Miami, Montreal, Quebec City, Tampa or Toronto.

8 THE TOGGLE

On the lobby rug lay a small wooden toggle. Of the four kinds of coat in the register, only a Duffle coat is fastened with toggles.

The thief's Coat is Duffle.

9 THE CREAKING CEILING

That evening, the thief complained to Gus about footsteps creaking overhead. Rooms stack neatly: the room directly above Room 305 is Room 405. (Rooms on the 5th floor have only the attic above them, which is empty.)

The room directly above the thief's room has at least one guest listed on this register.

10 THE INITIAL

The snow globe was found at last, wrapped in a pillowcase monogrammed with the initial of the surname it had been embroidered for: a letter from N to Z. The thief had brought it from home.

The thief's surname begins with a letter from N to Z.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE SNOW GLOBE?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Left										

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE EIGHT

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

THE GHOST OF THE EAST STAIRS



110 suspects · 11 clues · Difficulty ****

AT one o'clock on Friday morning, Mr. Grayle was coming back from a late-night conversation with the lodge's telephone (the lines were down, but he talked to it anyway) when he met a ghost on the 2nd-floor landing.

It was a tall, white, wobbly ghost, with two holes for eyes, and it said "Woouoooo" in a voice like a tea kettle. It announced that it was the Grey Lady of Frostwood, that it had haunted the lodge for a hundred years, and that it did not care for "men who knock down old buildings." Then it fled up the East stairs with a clatter and was gone.

Mr. Grayle, it must be said, was not frightened. He was delighted. He woke Mr. Pemberton to tell him about it. "A haunted hotel, Pemberton! Guests pay double for a ghost! When I own the place, I'll put it on the brochure!" Mr. Pemberton, who had been fast asleep, said something that Pippa has promised not to write down.

In the morning, a bedsheet with two eye-holes was found stuffed down the laundry chute, along with a keyring and, a little further along the stairs, an empty mug.

Pippa gathered up every scrap of evidence, and then drew up a list of the one hundred and ten guests who could have been on the East stairs at one in the morning. Next to each name she wrote their usual Bedtime (from Dot's turn-down list) and their Nightcap (from the kitchen's order book). "There's no such thing as ghosts," she told you firmly. "But there is such a thing as a guest in a sheet."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 110 guests who could have been on the East stairs early on Friday morning, listed alphabetically by surname, with their usual Bedtime and Nightcap. The first digit of a room number is the floor; the last two digits tell you where the room is on its corridor (see How to Solve a Case). Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Bedtime	Nightcap
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	10 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Cheeseman, Piers	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Cheeseman, Violet	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Baker	10 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Cheeseman, Winnie	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	11 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Midnight	Chamomile
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	9 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	10 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	11 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Honeycutt, Bertram	320	Sunday	Anchorage	Florist	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	Midnight	Chamomile
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	9 p.m.	Peppermint

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Bedtime	Nightcap
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	Saturday	Chicago	Student	11 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	Saturday	Denver	Pilot	11 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	9 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	10 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Midnight	Chamomile
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	9 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	11 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	9 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	11 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	Friday	Denver	Engineer	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	Friday	Denver	Architect	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	11 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	11 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	9 p.m.	Chamomile

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Bedtime	Nightcap
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	10 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	10 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	9 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Midnight	Chamomile
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	10 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	10 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Winterbottom, Nora	517	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	11 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	11 p.m.	Cocoa
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	9 p.m.	Peppermint
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Midnight	Cocoa
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Midnight	Earl Grey
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	9 p.m.	Earl Grey
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Midnight	Peppermint
☐ Yelland, Lark	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	9 p.m.	Chamomile
☐ Yelland, Queenie	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	11 p.m.	Cocoa

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 WIDE AWAKE

The “ghost” appeared at one in the morning. Dot keeps a list of every guest’s usual bedtime for the evening turn-down service, and she is certain the early sleepers were snoring by midnight: she heard them. Only guests with a Bedtime of 11 p.m. or Midnight were still up and about.

The thief’s Bedtime is 11 p.m. or Midnight.

2 THE EAST CORRIDOR

The ghost swept off the East stairs and into the East Wing corridor, and the East Wing door locks behind anyone who goes through it without a room key for that wing. The East Wing holds the rooms whose last two digits are 11 to 20 on every floor (for example, 511 to 520).

The thief’s room number ends in 11 to 20.

3 UP THE STAIRS

Mr. Grayle, who met the ghost on the 2nd-floor landing, says it fled upwards “with a most unghostly clatter.” It went to its own room from there.

The thief’s room is on the 3rd, 4th or 5th floor.

4 DOT’S ROUNDS

Chamomile tea at Frostwood is brewed strong enough to send a moose to sleep. Everyone whose Nightcap was Chamomile was fast asleep before half past twelve; Dot checked on each of them.

The thief’s Nightcap is not Chamomile.

5 THE LAUNDRY TAG

The ghost's sheet was found stuffed down the laundry chute. Its laundry tag shows it came from a room made up with two or more beds, and only rooms shared by two or more guests are made up that way. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief shares a room with at least one other guest.

6 THE CARD TOWER

Every Pilot, Engineer and Architect at the lodge spent the whole night in the games room, building a tower of playing cards eleven storeys high. Nobody dared leave in case it fell down.

The thief is not a Pilot, an Engineer or an Architect.

7 THE MIDNIGHT SNACK

Every Student in the lodge was awake at one o'clock, sharing a secret midnight snack in their own room, and each one says their roommates never left. So the ghost does not share a room with a Student. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

None of the thief's roommates is a Student.

8 THUMPING

At ten past one, a guest rang the front desk to complain about "thumping and wailing" from the room directly above. Rooms stack neatly: the room directly above Room 314 is Room 414. The complaint came from the room directly below the thief's, and that caller is on this register. (1st-floor rooms have only the cellar below them.)

The room directly below the thief's room has at least one guest listed on this register.

9 THE GREY LADY

The ghost called itself "the Grey Lady of Frostwood." That legend is told only twice a week: at the Saturday welcome dinner (so every guest who arrived on Friday or Saturday heard it), and at the late-night story hour, which only guests with a Bedtime of Midnight attend.

At least one is true: the thief arrived on Friday or Saturday, or the thief's Bedtime is Midnight.

10 THE EMPTY MUG

On the stairs where the ghost vanished stood an empty mug with a little ring in the bottom that smelled of chocolate and mint. Only Cocoa and Peppermint nightcaps are served in mugs; Earl Grey comes in a china cup.

The thief's Nightcap is Cocoa or Peppermint.

11 THE SUBWAY TOKEN

Tangled in the sheet was a keyring with a subway token on it. The thief said, "I always keep one for the ride home." Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these have an underground subway line: Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Los Angeles, Montreal and Toronto.

The thief lives in Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Los Angeles, Montreal or Toronto.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO WAS THE GHOST?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
Left											

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE NINE

DETECTIVE'S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE TEN · FRIDAY EVENING

THE SILENT QUARTET



125 suspects · 12 clues · Difficulty ****

EVERY year the Pinewood String Quartet travels up the mountain to play at Frostwood, and every year they close the Talent Evening with the *Frostwood Waltz*. This year they had been snowed in along with everybody else, which they did not mind at all, because Mrs. Brisket had been feeding them.

The Talent Evening began at eight o'clock on Friday. one hundred and twenty-five guests had signed up: some to perform (Singing, Magic, Juggling, Poetry or Piano) and some simply to sit in the Audience and clap. Everybody performing had been given a rehearsal slot in the ballroom that afternoon, at 4 p.m., 5 p.m., 6 p.m. or 7 p.m.

At half past six the quartet's leader went to the Music Room to fetch the instruments, and came back looking as if she had seen a second ghost. The violins, the viola and the cello were all present and correct. But all four bows had disappeared, and so had every page of sheet music.

"We can't play the *Waltz* without bows," she said. "We can't play anything without bows."

"The finale is ruined!" wailed Mr. Pemberton.

Mr. Grayle, in a velvet jacket, looked around the ballroom at all the disappointed faces, and for once did not say anything clever at all.

Pippa, however, was already at work. She had the list of every Act and every Rehearsal time, and in twenty minutes she had collected twelve clues. "There's still time," she said. "If we find the bows before nine, the quartet can still play."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 125 guests registered for Friday's Talent Evening, listed alphabetically by surname, with their Act and their Rehearsal slot. The first digit of a room number is the floor; the last two digits tell you where the room is on its corridor (see How to Solve a Case). Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Act	Rehearsal
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Poetry	5 p.m.
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	Juggling	5 p.m.
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Singing	7 p.m.
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Poetry	4 p.m.
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Poetry	7 p.m.
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Magic	5 p.m.
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Piano	7 p.m.
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse	Singing	7 p.m.
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Piano	7 p.m.
☐ Cheeseman, Piers	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Audience	6 p.m.
☐ Cheeseman, Violet	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Baker	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Cheeseman, Winnie	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Singing	6 p.m.
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	Magic	5 p.m.
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	Saturday	Miami	Doctor	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	Saturday	Miami	Tailor	Juggling	5 p.m.
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Juggling	5 p.m.
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Audience	4 p.m.
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Singing	6 p.m.
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Frost, Gracie	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Frost, Monty	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Pilot	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Juggling	4 p.m.
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	Piano	4 p.m.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Act	Rehearsal
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Poetry	4 p.m.
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	Audience	4 p.m.
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Poetry	7 p.m.
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	Piano	4 p.m.
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	Singing	7 p.m.
☐ Ivers, Gideon	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Teacher	Piano	4 p.m.
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	Audience	6 p.m.
☐ Jarvis, Gertie	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Chef	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Jarvis, Vivian	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Piano	4 p.m.
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Poetry	7 p.m.
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Poetry	5 p.m.
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Audience	6 p.m.
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Poetry	4 p.m.
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Knightley, Silas	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Magic	6 p.m.
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	Saturday	Denver	Pilot	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Poetry	7 p.m.
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Poetry	5 p.m.
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Poetry	5 p.m.
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Magic	6 p.m.
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Audience	4 p.m.
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Juggling	4 p.m.
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Magic	6 p.m.
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Audience	4 p.m.
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Poetry	5 p.m.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Act	Rehearsal
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	Singing	6 p.m.
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Singing	6 p.m.
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Piano	7 p.m.
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Magic	7 p.m.
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Poetry	7 p.m.
☐ Quill, Alma	408	Saturday	Los Angeles	Pilot	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	Friday	Denver	Engineer	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	Friday	Denver	Architect	Singing	4 p.m.
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	Singing	7 p.m.
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Audience	6 p.m.
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Audience	5 p.m.
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Juggling	5 p.m.
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Singing	5 p.m.
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Poetry	4 p.m.
☐ Trelawney, Clara	410	Friday	Phoenix	Tailor	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Piano	7 p.m.
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Singing	6 p.m.
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Magic	4 p.m.
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Juggling	4 p.m.
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Audience	7 p.m.
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Singing	5 p.m.
☐ Whitlock, Ivy	211	Sunday	Quebec City	Doctor	Piano	5 p.m.
☐ Winterbottom, Nora	517	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Poetry	6 p.m.
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Juggling	5 p.m.
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Juggling	4 p.m.
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Juggling	6 p.m.
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Piano	7 p.m.
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Juggling	7 p.m.
☐ Yelland, Lark	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Piano	6 p.m.
☐ Yelland, Queenie	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Piano	4 p.m.
☐ Young, June	407	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Magic	6 p.m.
☐ Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Singing	5 p.m.

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 BALLROOM REHEARSAL

The bows and music vanished from the Music Room between a quarter to six and a quarter past. Everyone with a 6 p.m. Rehearsal was in the ballroom at that time, rehearsing under Pippa's stern eye.

The thief's Rehearsal is not 6 p.m.

2 BACKSTAGE PASS

The Music Room can only be reached through the backstage corridor, and on Talent Evening only performers are allowed backstage. Guests whose Act is Audience were not performing and were stopped at the curtain.

The thief's Act is not Audience.

3 THE DRESSING ROOM

The Poetry and Magic performers shared a dressing room with the quartet's cellist, who was mending a string all evening and says none of them left the room before the show.

The thief's Act is not Poetry and not Magic.

4 THE LAUNDRY CHUTE

The quartet's sheet music was found at the bottom of the laundry chute. The chute has hatches only on the 2nd and 4th floors, and the thief used the one on their own floor.

The thief's room is on the 2nd or 4th floor.

5 FLUTTERING PAGES

At ten past six, one loose page of music was seen fluttering past a window on the mountain side of the lodge, dropped by the thief from their own room. On every floor, the rooms on the mountain side have even numbers.

The thief's room number is even.

6 QUIET ABOVE

The thief spent an hour practising scales on a borrowed bow, loudly and badly, and nobody complained. Rooms stack neatly: the room directly above Room 214 is Room 314. Every guest on this register was in their room at that hour, so the room above the thief's must have had no one from this register in it. (5th-floor rooms have only the empty attic above them.)

No guest on this register is staying in the room directly above the thief's room.

7 SETTING THE STAGE

Every Violinist, Tailor and Photographer at the lodge spent the afternoon and evening in the Great Hall, building the stage, stitching the curtains and setting up the lights.

The thief is not a Violinist, a Tailor or a Photographer.

8 THE QUARTET'S DINNER

The thief knew exactly which case held the bows. The quartet had shown off their bows, case and all, only once: when they played at the Saturday welcome dinner. Sunday arrivals missed it.

The thief arrived on Friday or Saturday.

9 TWO POSSIBILITIES

Pippa found a rehearsal timetable in the Music Room with a scribbled note in French. Either the thief rehearsed at 4 p.m. (the only slot that would have given time to scout the Music Room), or the thief lives in one of the Canadian home cities (Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto), where French is taught in every school, or both.

At least one is true: the thief's Rehearsal is 4 p.m., or the thief lives in Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto.

10 A ROOM OF ONE'S OWN

Nobody noticed the thief come and go with a violin case full of bows. Every guest who shares a room says their roommates were in all evening, and none of them had a violin case. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief is staying in a room alone.

11 THE NAME CARD

The thief's name card from the talent show running order was found crumpled in the chute. Only the first letter of the surname survived: a letter from **A** to **M**.

The thief's surname begins with a letter from A to M.

12 ROSIN ON THE CUFF

The thief's cuffs were dusted with rosin, the sticky powder rubbed on bows. Mrs. Brisket noticed it at supper, and the only acts that had been practising with their hands near the rosin were Singing (the singers were holding the sheet music) and Piano.

The thief's Act is Singing or Piano.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO SILENCED THE QUARTET?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Left												

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE TEN

DETECTIVE'S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

CASE ELEVEN · SATURDAY MORNING

THE MASTER KEY



138 suspects · 13 clues · Difficulty ****

MR. Pemberton's master key opens every door at Frostwood: every bedroom, every cupboard, the wine cellar, the boiler room and the little locked door to the old attic, which nobody has opened in years. It hangs on a brass hook in his office, just off the dining room, and it has never, ever gone missing.

On Saturday morning, between half past seven and half past eight, it went missing.

Mr. Pemberton discovered it at twenty to nine, when he went to fetch the key to the linen cupboard and found the hook empty and sticky. "Everything!" he said, sitting down suddenly. "It opens *everything!*"

Mr. Grayle, who had followed him into the office to talk about contracts, looked at the empty hook. Then he looked at Mr. Pemberton, who was very pale. "Let me get you a cup of tea, Alphonse," he said, which was the first time anyone had heard him use Mr. Pemberton's first name.

Breakfast at Frostwood is served at eight tables in the dining room, and each guest is given a paper ticket with their table number printed on it. Mrs. Brisket keeps a record of what everyone ate, because she likes to know. Between the tickets, Mrs. Brisket's record and a very determined morning of questions, Pippa put together a list of the one hundred and thirty-eight guests who could have gone near the office. "Thirteen clues," she said, a little breathlessly. "This is the hardest one yet."

Turn the page to open the Register.

REGISTER



These are the 138 guests who could have been near Mr. Pemberton's office on Saturday morning, listed alphabetically by surname, with their Breakfast and their dining-room Table. The first digit of a room number is the floor; the last two digits tell you where the room is on its corridor (see How to Solve a Case). Guests who share a room have the same room number.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Breakfast	Table
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Fruit	3
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	Kippers	8
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Porridge	5
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Kippers	1
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Porridge	2
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Porridge	1
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	Pancakes	3
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Skipped	4
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Eggs	8
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Pancakes	1
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Porridge	1
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Eggs	3
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	Porridge	6
☐ Cheeseman, Piers	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Skipped	6
☐ Cheeseman, Violet	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Baker	Fruit	6
☐ Cheeseman, Winnie	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Fruit	5
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Eggs	2
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	Porridge	4
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Pancakes	7
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Eggs	5
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	Saturday	Miami	Doctor	Pancakes	3
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	Saturday	Miami	Tailor	Kippers	5
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Skipped	8
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Fruit	7
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Pancakes	4
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Porridge	2
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Fruit	1
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Pancakes	2
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Eggs	5
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	Kippers	4
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Skipped	4
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Porridge	6
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Pancakes	2
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Kippers	6
☐ Frost, Gracie	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Kippers	4
☐ Frost, Monty	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Pilot	Eggs	3
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Pancakes	2

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Breakfast	Table
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	Kippers	2
☐ Gosling, Lillian	103	Sunday	Toronto	Painter	Eggs	3
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Kippers	5
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Fruit	2
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Kippers	2
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Eggs	2
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Skipped	8
☐ Honeycutt, Bertram	320	Sunday	Anchorage	Florist	Eggs	8
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Fruit	3
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Pancakes	4
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	Skipped	6
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	Eggs	7
☐ Ivers, Gideon	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Teacher	Porridge	7
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	Kippers	4
☐ Jarvis, Gertie	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Chef	Pancakes	7
☐ Jarvis, Vivian	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Pancakes	6
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Skipped	7
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	Fruit	4
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Kippers	3
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Porridge	2
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Eggs	1
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Porridge	8
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Eggs	6
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Skipped	4
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Eggs	4
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Porridge	5
☐ Knightley, Silas	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Porridge	4
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	Saturday	Denver	Pilot	Fruit	6
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Eggs	8
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Skipped	2
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Skipped	8
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Skipped	3
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Kippers	2
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Kippers	7
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	Pancakes	7
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Kippers	2
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Pancakes	6
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Skipped	5
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Skipped	6
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Porridge	7
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	Kippers	8
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	Eggs	6
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Eggs	8
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Eggs	3
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Pancakes	1
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Kippers	6

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Breakfast	Table
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Fruit	1
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	Kippers	4
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Eggs	5
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Pancakes	4
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Pancakes	3
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Porridge	4
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Porridge	3
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Porridge	7
☐ Quill, Alma	408	Saturday	Los Angeles	Pilot	Porridge	5
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	Friday	Denver	Engineer	Skipped	6
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	Friday	Denver	Architect	Eggs	6
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	Skipped	4
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	Kippers	4
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Skipped	3
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Skipped	8
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	Porridge	3
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Porridge	6
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	Porridge	5
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Porridge	8
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Eggs	3
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Porridge	7
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Eggs	7
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	Fruit	2
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	Fruit	6
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	Pancakes	4
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Pancakes	2
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Eggs	3
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Kippers	7
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer	Porridge	8
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer	Skipped	8
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Porridge	3
☐ Trelawney, Clara	410	Friday	Phoenix	Tailor	Skipped	7
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Eggs	4
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Fruit	7
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Fruit	3
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Pancakes	2
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Skipped	1
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Porridge	3
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	Skipped	2
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	Pancakes	4
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Fruit	7
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Pancakes	1
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Kippers	2
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Kippers	6
☐ Whitlock, Ivy	211	Sunday	Quebec City	Doctor	Fruit	1
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Eggs	6

	Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	Breakfast	Table
☐	Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Pancakes	3
☐	Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Eggs	1
☐	Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Skipped	7
☐	Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Fruit	5
☐	Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Pancakes	3
☐	Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Fruit	2
☐	Yelland, Lark	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Pancakes	8
☐	Yelland, Queenie	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Porridge	4
☐	Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Kippers	4

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 THROUGH THE DINING ROOM

Mr. Pemberton's office can only be reached through the dining room, and Gus was watching the other door. Guests who Skipped breakfast never came into the dining room.

The thief's Breakfast is not Skipped.

2 SYRUP ON THE HOOK

The key hook was sticky with golden syrup. At Frostwood, golden syrup is served only with Porridge and Pancakes.

The thief's Breakfast is Porridge or Pancakes.

3 THE BREAKFAST TICKET

Every breakfast ticket has the guest's table number and room number printed on it. Half of the thief's ticket was found under the hook, and Pippa worked out one thing from it: the table number was greater than the floor number (the floor is the first digit of the room number).

The thief's Table number is greater than the thief's floor number.

4 THE CHESS TOURNAMENT

Every Accountant and every Lawyer in the lodge was playing in the Saturday chess tournament in the games room, which began at seven sharp and did not break for breakfast.

The thief is not an Accountant and not a Lawyer.

5 BREAKFAST IN BED

On Saturdays it is a Frostwood tradition that every guest on the 3rd floor is served breakfast in bed. Dot carried up every tray herself, and every one of those guests was still in bed when she collected the trays at nine.

The thief is not staying on the 3rd floor.

6 THE NEIGHBOUR'S KNOCK

The thief was seen slipping the key into the room next door to their own, to hide it. Next door means the room two numbers higher or lower on the same floor and the same side of the corridor (Room 407 is next door to 405 and 409; Room 401 has only 403 beside it; Room 420 has only 418).

At least one room next door to the thief's room has a guest listed on this register.

7 NOBODY ACROSS THE HALL

Nobody saw the thief come or go, not even the guest across the hall. Across the hall means the facing room: every odd-numbered room faces the next even number (Room 305 faces 306; Room 419 faces 420). The room across the hall from the thief's has no one from this register in it.

No guest on this register is staying in the room directly across the hall from the thief's room.

8 GENTLE WINTERS

The thief was heard grumbling that the snow “never lets up,” and that winters back home are gentle and green. Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, these have gentle, snowless winters: Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego and Tampa.

The thief lives in Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego or Tampa.

9 COMPANY

At seven o'clock Dot saw the thief slip out of their room, whispering “Go back to sleep, I'll bring you some breakfast,” to somebody still inside. (Guests who share a room have the same room number in the register.)

The thief shares a room with at least one other guest.

10 A FAMILY AFFAIR

The sleepy voice inside answered, “Thank you, my darling grandchild.” So the thief is sharing a room with a relative, and in this register, relatives travelling together always share a surname.

At least one other guest in the thief's room has the same surname as the thief.

11 EVEN STEVENS

On Saturdays Mrs. Brisket serves the even-numbered tables first. The thief finished early and was at the key hook while the odd-numbered tables were still waiting for their toast.

The thief's Table number is even.

12 THE PANCAKE LESSON

Every guest at Table 4 spent breakfast in the kitchen, where Mrs. Brisket was teaching them to flip pancakes. The ceiling still has evidence.

The thief's Table is not 4.

13 THE NAME TAG

Pippa found the thief's paper name tag in the dining room fireplace, half burnt. The first name and surname were both still readable except for the middle letters, and she counted: the first name was shorter than the surname.

The thief's first name has fewer letters than the thief's surname.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO TOOK THE MASTER KEY?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Left													

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE ELEVEN

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

THE FORGED FOUNDER



152 suspects · 14 clues · Difficulty ****

IN the lobby of the Frostwood Lodge hangs the portrait of Josephine Frost, who built the lodge in 1901 with her own savings and, according to legend, a good deal of her own carpentry. She is painted in a dark green coat, standing in the snow, with the lodge behind her and a look on her face that says she will not be argued with. Tomorrow is the lodge's 125th birthday, and the party is to be held beneath her.

At afternoon tea on Saturday, Lady Winifred came down from the Summit Suite especially to look at the portrait, as she does once every year. She looked at it for a long moment. Then she put down her teacup.

"That," said Lady Winifred, "is not Josephine."

She was right. On close inspection, the painting was a copy: a very good one, but the varnish was only a day old, the frame had been screwed on with shiny new screws, and there were tiny initials in the corner that had never been there before. Somebody had taken the real portrait and hung a copy in its place, and Gus's night log showed that the swap must have happened on Friday night, between eleven o'clock and midnight.

Mr. Pemberton sat down on the stairs and put his head in his hands. "Josephine," he said. "On her birthday."

And then an extraordinary thing happened. Mr. Grayle sat down on the stairs beside him. "We'll find her, Alphonse," he said. "Your detective hasn't failed yet."

This time there was no smaller list. On Friday night, any guest in the lodge could have crossed the lobby. So Pippa, with the help of Gus, Dot and a great deal of cocoa, drew up a register of every single guest at Frostwood, all one hundred and fifty-two of them, with what each was doing at 11 p.m. and what each had on their feet. "Fourteen clues," she said. "It's the last case of the week. Let's make it a good one."

Turn the page to open the Register.

THE COMPLETE REGISTER



This register lists all 152 guests staying at Frostwood, alphabetically by surname, with what each was doing At 11 p.m. on Friday and the Shoes each wore. Every occupied room in the lodge appears here. The first digit of a room number is the floor; the last two digits tell you where the room is on its corridor (see How to Solve a Case). Guests who share a room have the same room number. The only empty rooms in the lodge are 101, 113, 204, 212, 301, 302, 305, 310, 314 and 316.

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 11 p.m.	Shoes
☐ Abernathy, Wilfred	104	Friday	Miami	Librarian	Library	Socks
☐ Aldridge, Birdie	119	Sunday	Montreal	Engineer	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Aldridge, Dorothy	119	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Appleby, Edmund	220	Sunday	Milwaukee	Painter	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Ashby, Constance	508	Saturday	Montreal	Doctor	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Bellweather, Una	413	Saturday	Minneapolis	Teacher	Library	Socks
☐ Birch, Felix	117	Saturday	Minneapolis	Baker	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Blackwood, Noel	414	Sunday	Montreal	Novelist	Asleep	Socks
☐ Blackwood, Percy	414	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Library	Sneakers
☐ Blackwood, Thea	414	Sunday	Montreal	Journalist	Sauna	Boots
☐ Bramble, Agatha	214	Saturday	Toronto	Nurse	Sauna	Slippers
☐ Brightwell, Jude	208	Sunday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Movie	Boots
☐ Carrington, Primrose	514	Friday	Phoenix	Accountant	Asleep	Sneakers
☐ Chalk, Maude	416	Friday	Anchorage	Librarian	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Cheeseman, Piers	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Cheeseman, Violet	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Baker	Movie	Boots
☐ Cheeseman, Winnie	218	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Cobbold, Harriet	518	Saturday	San Diego	Doctor	Movie	Boots
☐ Crumb, Vera	505	Saturday	Montreal	Beekeeper	Library	Slippers
☐ Dewberry, Fergus	104	Friday	Miami	Florist	Board Games	Boots
☐ Dimsdale, Adele	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Student	Asleep	Socks
☐ Dimsdale, Gwendolyn	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Movie	Sneakers
☐ Dimsdale, Ines	304	Saturday	Anchorage	Journalist	Board Games	Sneakers
☐ Drummond, Rosalind	501	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Library	Boots
☐ Dunmore, Ida	509	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Asleep	Boots
☐ Ellsworth, Gilbert	118	Saturday	Miami	Doctor	Board Games	Socks
☐ Ellsworth, Rhoda	118	Saturday	Miami	Tailor	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Elphick, Arthur	504	Sunday	Montreal	Teacher	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Elphick, Nigel	504	Sunday	Montreal	Florist	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Elphick, Otis	504	Sunday	Montreal	Student	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Ember, Edith	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Dentist	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Ember, Ernest	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Library	Sneakers
☐ Ember, Fitz	503	Friday	Los Angeles	Student	Library	Sneakers
☐ Everley, Magnus	519	Friday	Denver	Novelist	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Fairweather, Leopold	511	Sunday	Anchorage	Violinist	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Fenwick, Desmond	506	Sunday	Honolulu	Botanist	Stargazing	Socks

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 11 p.m.	Shoes
☐ Finch, Roland	215	Sunday	Honolulu	Pilot	Movie	Boots
☐ Foxley, Frank	409	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Board Games	Socks
☐ Foxley, Kitty	409	Sunday	San Diego	Dentist	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Frost, Gracie	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Photographer	Movie	Slippers
☐ Frost, Monty	309	Saturday	Anchorage	Pilot	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Gallagher, Flora	210	Saturday	Denver	Beekeeper	Movie	Sneakers
☐ Goodfellow, Tristan	317	Sunday	Milwaukee	Tailor	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Gosling, Lillian	103	Sunday	Toronto	Painter	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Greaves, Honor	404	Sunday	Chicago	Painter	Sauna	Socks
☐ Hargreaves, Ned	217	Saturday	Honolulu	Violinist	Board Games	Boots
☐ Hawthorne, Dexter	120	Saturday	Denver	Architect	Board Games	Sneakers
☐ Hawthorne, Ralph	120	Saturday	Denver	Photographer	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Hazelwood, Tilly	205	Sunday	Miami	Doctor	Board Games	Socks
☐ Hollis, Effie	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Journalist	Movie	Sneakers
☐ Hollis, Verity	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Dentist	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Hollis, Wendell	111	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Library	Socks
☐ Honeycutt, Bertram	320	Sunday	Anchorage	Florist	Sauna	Slippers
☐ Inchbald, Douglas	312	Friday	Denver	Violinist	Library	Sneakers
☐ Inchbald, Stanley	312	Friday	Denver	Botanist	Library	Sneakers
☐ Ingram, Juno	319	Sunday	San Diego	Pilot	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Ingram, Wynn	319	Sunday	San Diego	Tailor	Movie	Slippers
☐ Ivers, Gideon	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Teacher	Sauna	Boots
☐ Iveson, Beatrice	509	Sunday	Chicago	Architect	Library	Slippers
☐ Jarvis, Gertie	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Chef	Asleep	Boots
☐ Jarvis, Vivian	206	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Sauna	Boots
☐ Jessop, Jonah	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Jolliffe, Clement	403	Saturday	Quebec City	Photographer	Movie	Socks
☐ Juniper, Gordon	213	Saturday	Milwaukee	Librarian	Board Games	Boots
☐ Kemble, Amos	219	Saturday	Chicago	Beekeeper	Asleep	Boots
☐ Kemble, Hugo	219	Saturday	Chicago	Novelist	Library	Socks
☐ Kemble, Oscar	219	Saturday	Chicago	Student	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Kettering, Harold	311	Sunday	Boston	Pilot	Movie	Boots
☐ Kettering, Ophelia	311	Sunday	Boston	Tailor	Asleep	Socks
☐ Kingsley, Eleanor	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Teacher	Sauna	Slippers
☐ Kingsley, Xavier	105	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Asleep	Socks
☐ Knightley, Silas	116	Saturday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Library	Boots
☐ Larkspur, Elsie	501	Saturday	Denver	Pilot	Library	Boots
☐ Lockhart, Imogen	507	Saturday	Los Angeles	Florist	Board Games	Boots
☐ Loxley, Cecil	404	Sunday	Chicago	Florist	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Lumley, Frederick	102	Friday	Denver	Librarian	Board Games	Boots
☐ Lumley, Opal	102	Friday	Denver	Nurse	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Lumley, Posy	102	Friday	Denver	Student	Asleep	Socks
☐ Marchbanks, Viola	315	Sunday	San Diego	Baker	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Merritt, Theo	520	Saturday	Quebec City	Florist	Asleep	Boots
☐ Mottram, Rupert	318	Sunday	Denver	Tailor	Library	Socks
☐ Mulberry, Ulric	307	Saturday	Montreal	Baker	Movie	Slippers

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 11 p.m.	Shoes
☐ Nettles, Duncan	412	Friday	Honolulu	Doctor	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Nightingale, Cyril	216	Saturday	Honolulu	Florist	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Norwood, Cordelia	115	Friday	San Diego	Baker	Board Games	Socks
☐ Norwood, Sebastian	115	Friday	San Diego	Engineer	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Nuttall, Milo	412	Friday	Honolulu	Beekeeper	Library	Boots
☐ Oakley, Jem	306	Friday	Tampa	Nurse	Sauna	Boots
☐ Oakley, Kit	306	Friday	Tampa	Photographer	Sauna	Slippers
☐ Ogilvy, Minnie	110	Sunday	Phoenix	Beekeeper	Movie	Slippers
☐ Oxley, Barnaby	417	Friday	San Diego	Librarian	Movie	Boots
☐ Oxley, Linus	417	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Movie	Sneakers
☐ Parsley, Kenneth	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Nurse	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Parsley, Mavis	202	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Peabody, Zachary	406	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Library	Slippers
☐ Pennington, Basil	106	Sunday	Milwaukee	Novelist	Board Games	Boots
☐ Pickering, Lloyd	107	Friday	Phoenix	Painter	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Pickering, Phineas	107	Friday	Phoenix	Librarian	Asleep	Boots
☐ Pilbeam, Hazel	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Botanist	Library	Slippers
☐ Pilbeam, Isadora	516	Saturday	Buffalo	Chef	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Pryce, Tabitha	513	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Asleep	Boots
☐ Pryce, Yvonne	513	Sunday	Montreal	Tailor	Movie	Slippers
☐ Quill, Alma	408	Saturday	Los Angeles	Pilot	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Quimby, Enid	401	Friday	Denver	Engineer	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Quimby, Lavinia	401	Friday	Denver	Architect	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Radcliffe, Bernard	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Photographer	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Radcliffe, Daphne	411	Sunday	Phoenix	Journalist	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Ravenscroft, Fern	515	Saturday	Quebec City	Teacher	Library	Slippers
☐ Rowntree, Estelle	108	Saturday	Los Angeles	Nurse	Asleep	Slippers
☐ Rushworth, Sylvia	418	Sunday	Phoenix	Pilot	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Sallow, Victor	419	Sunday	Miami	Photographer	Library	Boots
☐ Sallow, Walter	419	Sunday	Miami	Chef	Library	Sneakers
☐ Snowden, Dudley	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Doctor	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Snowden, Horace	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Student	Asleep	Boots
☐ Snowden, Ignatius	313	Sunday	Phoenix	Lawyer	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Starling, Ursula	205	Sunday	Miami	Novelist	Sauna	Boots
☐ Summerby, Josephine	207	Friday	Montreal	Student	Asleep	Boots
☐ Summerby, Reggie	207	Friday	Montreal	Architect	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Summerby, Selma	207	Friday	Montreal	Painter	Sauna	Socks
☐ Tanner, Neville	303	Sunday	Boston	Librarian	Board Games	Boots
☐ Tanner, Quentin	303	Sunday	Boston	Dentist	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Thistlewood, Wallace	502	Sunday	Buffalo	Teacher	Sauna	Socks
☐ Tolliver, Nell	510	Saturday	Tampa	Engineer	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Tolliver, Odette	510	Saturday	Tampa	Photographer	Library	Slippers
☐ Tregarth, Florence	109	Saturday	Anchorage	Beekeeper	Asleep	Socks
☐ Trelawney, Clara	410	Friday	Phoenix	Tailor	Asleep	Socks
☐ Tuttle, Ruby	307	Saturday	Montreal	Tailor	Library	Boots
☐ Umber, Albert	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Movie	Boots

Guest	Room	Arrived	Home City	Occupation	At 11 p.m.	Shoes
☐ Umber, Lionel	203	Saturday	Buffalo	Beekeeper	Board Games	Slippers
☐ Underhill, Godfrey	420	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Library	Sneakers
☐ Upton, Jasper	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Beekeeper	Sauna	Sneakers
☐ Upton, Pearl	201	Saturday	Los Angeles	Violinist	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Valentine, Iris	112	Friday	Chicago	Dentist	Library	Sneakers
☐ Varley, Ada	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Tailor	Board Games	Boots
☐ Varley, Blanche	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Violinist	Stargazing	Boots
☐ Varley, Hattie	512	Saturday	Buffalo	Student	Board Games	Sneakers
☐ Vickers, Greta	208	Sunday	Montreal	Accountant	Library	Slippers
☐ Wetherby, Ivor	415	Friday	San Diego	Nurse	Sauna	Socks
☐ Wetherby, Wilhelmina	415	Friday	San Diego	Florist	Movie	Socks
☐ Whitlock, Ivy	211	Sunday	Quebec City	Doctor	Library	Sneakers
☐ Winterbottom, Nora	517	Sunday	San Diego	Nurse	Stargazing	Socks
☐ Woolley, Delphine	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Novelist	Board Games	Boots
☐ Woolley, Mabel	405	Friday	Minneapolis	Painter	Movie	Socks
☐ Wren, Humphrey	209	Sunday	Toronto	Architect	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Wren, Lottie	209	Sunday	Toronto	Student	Movie	Boots
☐ Wren, Olive	209	Sunday	Toronto	Botanist	Stargazing	Sneakers
☐ Yardley, Cora	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Chef	Asleep	Socks
☐ Yardley, Orla	308	Saturday	Minneapolis	Dentist	Stargazing	Slippers
☐ Yelland, Lark	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Library	Sneakers
☐ Yelland, Queenie	114	Sunday	Los Angeles	Tailor	Sauna	Slippers
☐ Young, June	407	Friday	Chicago	Chef	Library	Boots
☐ Zeller, Toby	402	Sunday	Milwaukee	Dentist	Library	Sneakers

THE EVIDENCE

CLUES



Apply the clues in order, crossing suspects off the register as you go.

1 AWAKE AT ELEVEN

The portrait was swapped some time between 11 p.m. and midnight on Friday. Dot has confirmed with a peek round every door that guests listed as Asleep at 11 p.m. were indeed sound asleep until morning.

The thief was not Asleep at 11 p.m.

2 ONE WORD

The thief's luggage tag, found tied to the trolley, gave a home city whose name is a single word. Of the sixteen home cities that Frostwood guests come from, the only ones with two-word names are Los Angeles, Quebec City and San Diego.

The thief does not live in Los Angeles, Quebec City or San Diego.

3 THE FRIDAY QUIZ

Every Doctor, Nurse, Dentist and Teacher in the lodge was in the Great Hall until one in the morning, locked in the final round of the Friday Night Quiz.

The thief is not a Doctor, a Nurse, a Dentist or a Teacher.

4 THE ROOF TERRACE

The swap happened at half past eleven. At that moment the Stargazing group was up on the roof terrace with Pippa and the lodge telescope, counting shooting stars, and nobody left before one.

The thief was not Stargazing at 11 p.m.

5 RUBBER SOLES

Dot found a faint print on the polished lobby floor: a ridged rubber sole. Of the shoes in the register, only Boots and Sneakers have ridged rubber soles; Slippers and Socks leave no ridges.

The thief's Shoes are Boots or Sneakers.

6 THE LUGGAGE TROLLEY

The real portrait, in its heavy frame, was wheeled away on the luggage trolley and into the lift. The lift's log shows it stopped only at the 1st, 3rd and 5th floors that night, and the thief took the trolley to their own floor.

The thief's room is on the 1st, 3rd or 5th floor.

7 THE STEAM ROOM

The sauna closes at half past eleven, and at that moment Gus was at the sauna door handing out towels. Everyone listed in the Sauna at 11 p.m. walked out past him, pink and steaming, and went straight to the Great Hall for cocoa.

The thief was not in the Sauna at 11 p.m.

8 THE QUIET WING

The thief chose the lift because it is quiet, and the lift opens straight into the West Wing. The West Wing holds the rooms whose last two digits are 01 to 10 on every floor (for example, 301 to 310).

The thief's room number ends in 01 to 10.

9 THE WINTER GARDEN

Every Beekeeper, Botanist and Florist at Frostwood spent the evening in the Winter Garden at a lecture called *What Do Bees Do in the Snow?*, which ran until well after midnight.

The thief is not a Beekeeper, a Botanist or a Florist.

10 THE READERS' LOCK-IN

Friday night is the Late Readers' Lock-In. At eleven o'clock the librarian, Miss Lettice, locked the library door with everybody listed in the Library inside, and unlocked it again at one.

The thief was not in the Library at 11 p.m.

11 MOUNTAIN LIGHT

Painters love the soft morning light on the mountain side of the lodge, and a fresh smear of varnish was found on the windowsill of a mountain-side room. On every floor, the rooms on the mountain side have even numbers.

The thief's room number is even.

12 IF THE MOVIE, THEN SNEAKERS

Everyone at the late Movie in the games room had to take their boots off at the door and wear their own shoes. Pippa worked out this rule from the footprints: if the thief was at the Movie, the thief was wearing Sneakers; if the thief was anywhere else, the thief was wearing Boots.

Either the thief was at the Movie and wore Sneakers, or the thief was not at the Movie and wore Boots.

13 PAINT FUMES

The guest in the room across the hall from the thief's complained to Dot about "a smell of paint" coming from over the way. Across the hall means the facing room: every odd-numbered room faces the next even number (Room 105 faces 106; Room 519 faces 520). Every guest in the lodge is on this register.

The room directly across the hall from the thief's room is occupied (at least one guest on the register is staying in it).

14 THE SIGNATURE

The copy of the portrait was signed in the corner, very small, with the copier's own initials. The first initial comes later in the alphabet than the second: the first letter of the thief's first name comes after the first letter of their surname.

The first letter of the thief's first name comes later in the alphabet than the first letter of the thief's surname.

YOUR VERDICT

WHO SWAPPED THE PORTRAIT?



When only one name remains on the register, write it here, then turn to the solution at the back of the book.

Suspects left after each clue (the solutions give these numbers too):

Clue	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Left														

THE CULPRIT IS:

ROOM:

WHY I'M SURE:

CASE TWELVE

DETECTIVE’S NOTES



Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dashed lines.

STUCK?

HINTS



A nudge for each case, without giving the answer away. Try the hints before you turn to the solutions.

CASE ONE • THE COCOA TIN

- * **Clue 4** (*The Landing*) is about floors: look only at the first digit of each room number.
- * **Clue 3** (*Plain Cocoa*) and **Clue 6** (*The Sticky Shelf*) both use the Topping column. Apply them in order anyway; the solutions count each one separately.

CASE TWO • THE SNOWMAN'S HAT

- * **Clue 4** (*The East Door*) is about the last two digits of the room number: 11 to 20 is the East Wing.
- * **Clue 5** (*Snowmen Back Home*) lists exactly six cities. Anyone from any other city is cleared.

CASE THREE • THE STARLIGHT SAPPHIRE

- * **Clue 8** (*Nobody to Vouch*) is about sharing a room: look for any other guest on the register with the same room number, even one you have already crossed off.
- * **Clue 5** (*The Clicking Door*): even room numbers end in 0, 2, 4, 6 or 8.

CASE FOUR • THE SALTED SPONGE

- * **Clue 6** (*The Apron*) is about the first name, not the surname.
- * **Clue 5** (*A Whispered Word*): a suspect shares a room if any other guest on the register has the same room number.

CASE FIVE • THE MISSING FIRST EDITION

- * **Clue 4** (*Two Teacups*) needs exactly two guests in the room: not one, and not three.
- * **Clue 9** (*The Signature*): count the letters in the surname. Seven or more letters survive.

CASE SIX • THE TANGLED LACES

- * **Clue 3** (*The Lake View*): odd room numbers end in 1, 3, 5, 7 or 9.
- * **Clue 4** (*Where's the Shed?*) keeps only Sunday arrivals.

CASE SEVEN • THE MIDNIGHT FEAST

- * **Clue 8** (*Plaid or Bunny*) is an either/or clue. A suspect with Plaid pyjamas *and* Bunny slippers is cleared, and so is a suspect with neither.
- * **Clue 10** (*The Borrowed Key*): look at everyone else sharing the suspect's room, including roommates you have already crossed off. At least one of them must be a Chef or a Baker.

CASE EIGHT • THE SNOW GLOBE

- * **Clue 5** (*Across the Hall*): find the facing room (an odd room faces the next even number, so 417 faces 418) and see whether anybody on the register is staying there, crossed off or not.
- * **Clue 9** (*The Creaking Ceiling*): the room directly above has the same last two digits and a first digit one higher. A 5th-floor room has nothing above it.

CASE NINE • THE GHOST OF THE EAST STAIRS

- * **Clue 9** (*The Grey Lady*) is an 'at least one' clue: a Sunday arrival survives only if their Bedtime is Midnight.
- * **Clue 7** (*The Midnight Snack*): check every roommate of each suspect. If any of them is a Student, the suspect is cleared.
- * **Clue 8** (*Thumping*): the room directly below has the same last two digits and a first digit one lower.

CASE TEN • THE SILENT QUARTET

- * **Clue 6** (*Quiet Above*) clears a suspect if *anyone* on the register (crossed off or not) is staying in the room directly above.
- * **Clue 9** (*Two Possibilities*): keep a suspect if their Rehearsal is 4 p.m., or if they live in Montreal, Quebec City or Toronto, or both.

CASE ELEVEN • THE MASTER KEY

- * **Clue 3** (*The Breakfast Ticket*): compare the Table number with the first digit of the Room number. The Table must be bigger.
- * **Clue 6** (*The Neighbour's Knock*) and **Clue 7** (*Nobody Across the Hall*): next door is two numbers away on the same floor (Room 101 has only 103 beside it; Room 120 has only 118). Across the hall, odd faces the next even (113 faces 114).
- * **Clue 13** (*The Name Tag*): count the letters in the first name and in the surname.

CASE TWELVE • THE FORGED FOUNDER

- * The note above the register lists every empty room in the lodge, which helps with **Clue 13** (*Paint Fumes*).
- * **Clue 12** (*If the Movie, then Sneakers*) is an if/then clue: Movie-goers must be wearing Sneakers, and everyone else must be wearing Boots.
- * **Clue 14** (*The Signature*): compare the first letter of the first name with the first letter of the surname. *Zelda Abbott* would survive (Z comes after A); *Abe Zimmer* would not.

NO PEEKING UNTIL YOU'RE DONE

SOLUTIONS



Each solution shows how many suspects every clue clears, then reveals the culprit and what really happened.

CASE ONE · THE COCOA TIN · SOLUTION

DEXTER HAWTHORNE



Room 120 · Architect from Denver

Starting suspects: 40

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Fireside Chairs. Guests seated at the Fireside are cleared.	14	26
2. Early to Bed. Friday arrivals are cleared.	3	23
3. Plain Cocoa. Guests who took Nothing on top are cleared.	9	14
4. The Landing. Guests on floors 3, 4 and 5 are cleared.	5	9
5. Snow Back Home. Guests from Honolulu, Los Angeles, Miami, Phoenix, San Diego and Tampa are cleared.	3	6
6. The Sticky Shelf. Everyone who did not take Marshmallows is cleared.	5	1

Before the final clue, six suspects remained: Flora Gallagher (Room 210), Ralph Hawthorne (Room 120), Gordon Juniper (Room 213), Amos Kemble (Room 219), Hugo Kemble (Room 219) and Dexter Hawthorne (Room 120). The final clue, *The Sticky Shelf*, says: *The thief's Topping is Marshmallows*. Only Dexter fits, so Dexter Hawthorne is the culprit.

The tin was found under Dexter's pillow, its lid still firmly shut. It turned out that Dexter Hawthorne, an architect from Denver, had simply been desperate to know what was in *Brisket's Blend*, but the famous lid is stuck fast and only opens for Mrs. Brisket. "I tried for two hours," Dexter admitted. Mrs. Brisket was so pleased that her tin had defeated a professional that she forgave Dexter on the spot, on condition of washing every cocoa mug for the rest of the week. She opened the lid with one flick of her thumb, and cocoa hour resumed that evening. Gus's scarf reached his knees.

CASE TWO · THE SNOWMAN’S HAT · SOLUTION

VERITY HOLLIS



Room 111 · Dentist from Buffalo

Starting suspects: 48

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Judging Line. The Blue team is cleared.	11	37
2. Junior Judges. Teachers and Students are cleared.	3	34
3. The Welcome-Dinner Joke. Sunday arrivals are cleared.	6	28
4. The East Door. West Wing guests (rooms ending 01 to 10) are cleared.	17	11
5. Snowmen Back Home. Guests from every other city are cleared.	6	5
6. The Dropped Mitten. Surnames M to Z are cleared.	3	2
7. The Toffee Stick. Everyone whose Snack is not Toffee Apple is cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Effie Hollis (Room 111) and Verity Hollis (Room 111). The final clue, *The Toffee Stick*, says: *The thief’s Snack is Toffee Apple*. Only Verity fits, so Verity Hollis is the culprit.

The hat turned up that evening, perched on the head of the carved wooden moose in the lobby. Verity Hollis, a dentist from Buffalo, owned up at once. “The Colonel story is my family’s favourite,” Verity explained, “and I thought Sir Frostington deserved an adventure.” As for the toffee apple: “Dentists are allowed one a year,” said Verity with dignity. Mr. Pemberton decided that the moose looked rather distinguished in a top hat, and it is still wearing it. Mr. Grayle was heard to mutter that it was “unprofessional.” Gus’s scarf reached his ankles.

CASE THREE · THE STARLIGHT SAPPHIRE · SOLUTION

CYRIL NIGHTINGALE



Room 216 · Florist from Honolulu

Starting suspects: 60

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Back Stairs. Everyone on the 1st floor is cleared.	9	51
2. The Welcome Dinner. Sunday arrivals are cleared.	17	34
3. The Midnight Hiccups. Doctors and Nurses are cleared.	5	29
4. Borrowed Boots. Guests from the ten snowy cities are cleared.	19	10
5. The Clicking Door. Odd-numbered rooms are cleared.	5	5
6. The Monogram. Surnames A to M are cleared.	1	4
7. Out of Breath. The 5th-floor guests are cleared.	2	2
8. Nobody to Vouch. Everyone sharing a room is cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Milo Nuttall (Room 412) and Cyril Nightingale (Room 216). The final clue, *Nobody to Vouch*, says: *The thief is staying in a room alone*. Only Cyril fits, so Cyril Nightingale is the culprit.

Cyril Nightingale, a mild-mannered florist from Honolulu, had fallen head over heels for the Starlight Sapphire at Saturday’s dinner. “I only wanted to see it sparkle in the moonlight,” Cyril confessed, handing the necklace back from inside a hollowed-out hyacinth bulb. Lady Winifred, rather touched, decided not to press charges, on the condition that Cyril arrange the flowers for the lodge’s birthday party on Sunday. Mr. Grayle, who had been hoping for a scandal, looked disappointed. Gus’s scarf went twice round his chair.

CASE FOUR · THE SALTED SPONGE · SOLUTION

FRANK FOXLEY



Room 409 · Nurse from San Diego

Starting suspects: 64

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The West Pantry. Stations A and B are cleared.	31	33
2. The Judges' Table. Chefs and Bakers are cleared.	2	31
3. In the Oven. Scone and Pie bakers are cleared.	12	19
4. The Lift Indicator. Guests on floors 1, 2 and 5 are cleared.	10	9
5. A Whispered Word. Guests staying alone are cleared.	1	8
6. The Apron. First names N to Z are cleared.	2	6
7. Sea Salt. Guests from inland or lakeside cities are cleared.	4	2
8. Cinnamon Sugar. Sponge bakers are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Barnaby Oxley (Room 417) and Frank Foxley (Room 409). The final clue, *Cinnamon Sugar*, says: *The thief's Entry is Tart or Shortbread*. Only Frank fits, so Frank Foxley is the culprit.

The sugar jar was found on top of the wardrobe in Room 409. Frank Foxley, a nurse from San Diego, went rather pink. "I heard him practising his speech," Frank said. "He was going to announce that Frostwood would be knocked down, right there, at the Bake-Off, in front of everybody. I thought if he didn't win, he couldn't make the speech." Mr. Pemberton went pale; this was the first he had heard of any speech. Mr. Grayle said nothing at all, which was unusual, and later ate a second slice of the salty sponge when he thought nobody was looking. The Tart won. Gus's scarf was now long enough to use as a draught excluder.

CASE FIVE · THE MISSING FIRST EDITION · SOLUTION

IDA DUNMORE



Room 509 · Florist from Chicago

Starting suspects: 72

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Poetry Circle. Poetry borrowers are cleared.	7	65
2. The Late Jam Session. Violinists, Painters and Photographers are cleared.	11	54
3. The West Stairs. East Wing guests (rooms ending 11 to 20) are cleared.	22	32
4. Two Teacups. Guests staying alone or three to a room are cleared.	15	17
5. A Library Card. Friday arrivals are cleared.	5	12
6. The Author’s Tour. Guests from the other ten cities are cleared.	7	5
7. After Lunch. Morning visitors are cleared.	1	4
8. The Pressed Flower. Cookery and Science borrowers are cleared.	1	3
9. The Signature. Surnames of six letters or fewer are cleared.	2	1

Before the final clue, three suspects remained: Quentin Tanner (Room 303), Albert UMBER (Room 203) and Ida Dunmore (Room 509). The final clue, *The Signature*, says: *The thief’s surname has seven or more letters.* Only Ida fits, so Ida Dunmore is the culprit.

The first edition was found on Ida Dunmore’s bedside table with a bookmark in the very last chapter. Ida, a florist from Chicago, had owned a copy since childhood, but its final pages had been torn out long ago. “For thirty years I’ve wondered who did it,” Ida explained. “And there it was, behind glass, with the ending inside.” Miss Lettice, who understands these things, allowed Ida to finish the last chapter in the library, under supervision, with a cup of tea. (It was the vicar.) The library stayed open. Gus’s scarf had to be rolled up at night.

CASE SIX · THE TANGLED LACES · SOLUTION

DOROTHY ALDRIDGE



Room 119 · Tailor from Montreal

Starting suspects: 80

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Warming Up. Heat 1 skaters are cleared.	29	51
2. The First-Aid Tent. Doctors, Nurses and Dentists are cleared.	10	41
3. The Lake View. Even-numbered rooms are cleared.	17	24
4. Where's the Shed?. Friday and Saturday arrivals are cleared.	11	13
5. Frozen Ponds. Guests from the other nine cities are cleared.	7	6
6. The Hot-Water Bottles. Guests on the 4th and 5th floors are cleared.	2	4
7. Green Fluff. Red and Blue scarves are cleared.	1	3
8. The Sign-Up Sheet. Surnames N to Z are cleared.	1	2
9. Say Cheese. Heat 2 skaters are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Tristan Goodfellow (Room 317) and Dorothy Aldridge (Room 119). The final clue, *Say Cheese*, says: *The thief's Heat is not 2*. Only Dorothy fits, so Dorothy Aldridge is the culprit.

Dorothy Aldridge, a tailor from Montreal, came forward before you had even finished explaining. “I noticed the laces were fraying,” Dorothy said, “and I’d brought eighty brand-new waxed ones in my luggage, because I always do. I only meant to swap them. But I tied the old ones together to carry them, and the bundle got away from me, and then it was up in the gazebo and everybody was shouting, and I panicked.” The new laces were lovely. The race was won by a nine-year-old on the 2nd floor. Gus’s scarf now needed its own chair.

CASE SEVEN · THE MIDNIGHT FEAST · SOLUTION

KENNETH PARSLEY



Room 202 · Nurse from Minneapolis

Starting suspects: 90

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. The Crumb Trail. East Wing guests (rooms ending 11 to 20) are cleared.	37	53
2. Gus's Glimpse. Spotted and Plain pyjamas are cleared.	27	26
3. The Cold Stone Floor. Guests with no slippers are cleared.	9	17
4. The Midnight Movie. Students and Teachers are cleared.	4	13
5. Not the Ground Floor. 1st-floor guests are cleared.	3	10
6. The Postcard. Guests from Montreal, Quebec City and Toronto are cleared.	2	8
7. The Squeaky Board. Moccasin wearers are cleared.	2	6
8. Plaid or Bunny. Guests with both, or with neither, are cleared.	2	4
9. The Door Number. Odd-numbered rooms are cleared.	1	3
10. The Borrowed Key. Guests with no Chef or Baker among their roommates are cleared.	2	1

Before the final clue, three suspects remained: Desmond Fenwick (Room 506), Gertie Jarvis (Room 206) and Kenneth Parsley (Room 202). The final clue, *The Borrowed Key*, says: *Someone else in the thief's room is a Chef or a Baker*. Only Kenneth fits, so Kenneth Parsley is the culprit.

Kenneth Parsley, a nurse from Minneapolis, confessed with glaze still on one sleeve. “The staff,” Kenneth said. “They’re snowed in across the courtyard in the staff cottage, and they were going to miss the festival breakfast completely. Dot said so. So I borrowed my roommate’s larder key and took the buns over through the snow at one in the morning.” Mrs. Brisket, who had not thought of that, sat down heavily, then stood up and baked sixty more, and then another sixty for good measure. The staff sent a thank-you card signed by everyone, including the cat. Gus’s scarf reached the front door.

CASE EIGHT · THE SNOW GLOBE · SOLUTION

WALTER SALLOW



Room 419 · Chef from Miami

Starting suspects: 100

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Snow on the Carpet. Sauna, Library and Cards guests are cleared.	54	46
2. The Cloakroom. Cape wearers are cleared.	8	38
3. The Grand Staircase. Guests on floors 1 and 2 are cleared.	17	21
4. The Interview. Photographers, Journalists and Novelists are cleared.	4	17
5. Across the Hall. Guests whose facing room has nobody on the register are cleared.	5	12
6. The Dining Room. Friday arrivals are cleared.	1	11
7. Eastern Time. Guests from the other nine cities are cleared.	5	6
8. The Toggle. Parka and Fleece wearers are cleared.	3	3
9. The Creaking Ceiling. Guests with nobody on the register directly above are cleared.	1	2
10. The Initial. Surnames A to M are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Percy Blackwood (Room 414) and Walter Sallow (Room 419). The final clue, *The Initial*, says: *The thief's surname begins with a letter from N to Z*. Only Walter fits, so Walter Sallow is the culprit.

Walter Sallow, a chef from Miami, handed the snow globe back with both hands and a sheepish smile. "I had never seen snow fall, not once, until this week," Walter said. "And then it did, and it was the most beautiful thing I'd ever seen, and I wanted to take a little bit of it home. I only meant to keep it until Sunday. I've been shaking it every night before I go to sleep." Lady Winifred, hearing this, sent down a snow globe of her own, a tiny one with a polar bear in it, as a present. The Frostwood globe went back on the mantelpiece. Gus's scarf was now being knitted in the corridor.

CASE NINE · THE GHOST OF THE EAST STAIRS · SOLUTION

ISADORA PILBEAM



Room 516 · Chef from Buffalo

Starting suspects: 110

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Wide Awake. Guests with a 9 p.m. or 10 p.m. Bedtime are cleared.	58	52
2. The East Corridor. West Wing guests (rooms ending 01 to 10) are cleared.	26	26
3. Up the Stairs. Guests on floors 1 and 2 are cleared.	12	14
4. Dot's Rounds. Chamomile drinkers are cleared.	3	11
5. The Laundry Tag. Guests staying alone are cleared.	2	9
6. The Card Tower. Pilots, Engineers and Architects are cleared.	1	8
7. The Midnight Snack. Guests who share a room with a Student are cleared.	1	7
8. Thumping. Guests with nobody on the register directly below are cleared.	3	4
9. The Grey Lady. Sunday arrivals whose Bedtime is not Midnight are cleared.	1	3
10. The Empty Mug. Earl Grey drinkers are cleared.	1	2
11. The Subway Token. Guests from the other ten cities are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Victor Sallow (Room 419) and Isadora Pilbeam (Room 516). The final clue, *The Subway Token*, says: *The thief lives in Boston, Buffalo, Chicago, Los Angeles, Montreal or Toronto.* Only Isadora fits, so Isadora Pilbeam is the culprit.

Isadora Pilbeam, a chef from Buffalo, sewed the eye-holes in the sheet back up without being asked. “I thought if the lodge were haunted, he wouldn’t want to buy it,” Isadora explained. “I didn’t know ghosts were good for business.” Mr. Grayle laughed loudly at that. But when Isadora had gone, he asked Pippa, quite quietly, whether it was true that so many of the guests had been coming to Frostwood for years and years, and whether they really loved it that much. Pippa said yes. Mr. Grayle went away to think. Gus’s scarf had reached the 1st-floor landing.

CASE TEN · THE SILENT QUARTET · SOLUTION

AGATHA BRAMBLE



Room 214 · Nurse from Toronto

Starting suspects: 125

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Ballroom Rehearsal. 6 p.m. rehearsers are cleared.	31	94
2. Backstage Pass. Audience members are cleared.	16	78
3. The Dressing Room. Poets and Magicians are cleared.	29	49
4. The Laundry Chute. Guests on floors 1, 3 and 5 are cleared.	25	24
5. Fluttering Pages. Odd-numbered rooms are cleared.	9	15
6. Quiet Above. Guests with a registered guest directly above them are cleared.	8	7
7. Setting the Stage. Violinists, Tailors and Photographers are cleared.	1	6
8. The Quartet's Dinner. Sunday arrivals are cleared.	1	5
9. Two Possibilities. Guests with neither are cleared.	1	4
10. A Room of One's Own. Everyone sharing a room is cleared.	1	3
11. The Name Card. Surnames N to Z are cleared.	1	2
12. Rosin on the Cuff. Jugglers are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Flora Gallagher (Room 210) and Agatha Bramble (Room 214). The final clue, *Rosin on the Cuff*, says: *The thief's Act is Singing or Piano*. Only Agatha fits, so Agatha Bramble is the culprit.

The bows were in a violin case under the bed in Room 214, and the sheet music at the bottom of the laundry chute, a little crumpled but perfectly playable. Agatha Bramble, a nurse from Toronto, was found backstage, shaking. "I was supposed to sing just before the quartet," Agatha whispered, "and I have never been so frightened in my life. I thought if there were no finale, they might cancel the whole evening." The quartet's leader listened, and then did something marvellous: she asked Agatha to sing *with* them. At a quarter past nine, Agatha Bramble sang the *Frostwood Waltz* with the Pinewood String Quartet, and the ballroom rose to its feet. Mr. Grayle clapped loudest. Gus's scarf was used as a stage curtain.

CASE ELEVEN · THE MASTER KEY · SOLUTION

LARK YELLAND



Room 114 · Tailor from Los Angeles

Starting suspects: 138

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Through the Dining Room. Guests who Skipped breakfast are cleared.	22	116
2. Syrup on the Hook. Eggs, Fruit and Kippers eaters are cleared.	65	51
3. The Breakfast Ticket. Guests whose Table is equal to or smaller than their floor are cleared.	21	30
4. The Chess Tournament. Accountants and Lawyers are cleared.	1	29
5. Breakfast in Bed. 3rd-floor guests are cleared.	3	26
6. The Neighbour's Knock. Guests with no registered guest next door are cleared.	1	25
7. Nobody Across the Hall. Guests with a registered guest across the hall are cleared.	16	9
8. Gentle Winters. Guests from the ten snowy cities are cleared.	2	7
9. Company. Guests staying alone are cleared.	1	6
10. A Family Affair. Guests with no roommate of the same surname are cleared.	2	4
11. Even Stevens. Guests at odd-numbered tables are cleared.	1	3
12. The Pancake Lesson. Table 4 guests are cleared.	1	2
13. The Name Tag. Guests whose first name is as long as or longer than their surname are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Victor Sallow (Room 419) and Lark Yelland (Room 114). The final clue, *The Name Tag*, says: *The thief's first name has fewer letters than the thief's surname.* Only Lark fits, so Lark Yelland is the culprit.

Lark Yelland, a tailor from Los Angeles, returned the key with a dusty cobweb still hanging from it. “Grandma first came to Frostwood sixty years ago,” Lark explained, “and danced at the midwinter ball in a blue silk gown that was packed away in the attic and never found again. It’s her birthday tomorrow. I only wanted to find the dress and mend it for her, and I couldn’t ask for the key without spoiling the surprise.” The dress was found, in a trunk, in the attic, and

with it an old guest book going back to 1901. Mr. Pemberton was too relieved to be cross. Mr. Grayle spent the rest of the morning in the attic, reading the old guest book. Gus's scarf had become a local landmark.

CASE TWELVE · THE FORGED FOUNDER · SOLUTION

GWENDOLYN DIMSDALE



Room 304 · Photographer from Anchorage

Starting suspects: 152

CLUE	CLEARED	LEFT
1. Awake at Eleven. Guests who were Asleep are cleared.	29	123
2. One Word. Guests from Los Angeles, Quebec City and San Diego are cleared.	27	96
3. The Friday Quiz. Doctors, Nurses, Dentists and Teachers are cleared.	17	79
4. The Roof Terrace. Stargazers are cleared.	20	59
5. Rubber Soles. Slippers and Socks wearers are cleared.	23	36
6. The Luggage Trolley. Guests on the 2nd and 4th floors are cleared.	18	18
7. The Steam Room. Sauna guests are cleared.	2	16
8. The Quiet Wing. East Wing guests (rooms ending 11 to 20) are cleared.	7	9
9. The Winter Garden. Beekeepers, Botanists and Florists are cleared.	1	8
10. The Readers' Lock-In. Library guests are cleared.	3	5
11. Mountain Light. Odd-numbered rooms are cleared.	1	4
12. If the Movie, then Sneakers. Everyone breaking the Movie/Sneakers/Boots rule is cleared.	1	3
13. Paint Fumes. Guests whose facing room is empty are cleared.	1	2
14. The Signature. Guests whose first initial comes before or equals their surname initial are cleared.	1	1

Before the final clue, two suspects remained: Basil Pennington (Room 106) and Gwendolyn Dimsdale (Room 304). The final clue, *The Signature*, says: *The first letter of the thief's first name comes later in the alphabet than the first letter of the thief's surname.* Only Gwendolyn fits, so Gwendolyn Dimsdale is the culprit.

The real portrait of Josephine Frost was found in Room 304, propped carefully against the wall, wrapped in a quilt. Gwendolyn Dimsdale, a photographer from Anchorage, was sitting in front of it, holding a yellowed

envelope. “Josephine Frost was my great-great-grandmother,” Gwendolyn said quietly. “In her diary she wrote that she had hidden a letter ‘behind my own face, for whoever needs it most.’ I needed to look behind the portrait without anyone fussing, so I made a copy from my photographs and swapped them for one night. I was going to put her back before the party. I promise I was.”

EPILOGUE



THE letter was read aloud that evening in the lobby, beneath the real portrait, which was back on its hook where it belonged.

"To whoever needs this," Josephine Frost had written, in 1901. "I built this lodge so that travellers caught by the snow would always have somewhere warm to wait. It is not the building that matters. It is the waiting together: the cocoa, the stories, and the kindness of strangers who become friends. Whoever owns Frostwood, keep the fires lit."

There was a long silence. Then Mr. Grayle stood up, took his thick contract out of his velvet jacket, and, very slowly, tore it in half.

"I came here to buy a building," he said. "I seem to have spent a week in a family instead. My grandmother honeymooned here, you know; I found her name in the old guest book in the attic. I'd forgotten." He cleared his throat. "If Mr. Pemberton will allow it, I should like to pay for a new roof. And I should like to book the Tower Room for next winter. And the winter after that."

Mr. Pemberton could not speak, so he shook Mr. Grayle's hand for about a minute and a half.

The snowplough arrived on Sunday morning, just in time for the birthday party. The cocoa tin was on the serving table, the top hat was on the moose, the snow globe was on the mantelpiece, the Starlight Sapphire sparkled on Lady Winifred, and Josephine Frost watched over all of it with the look of someone who had known all along how it would turn out. Queenie Yelland danced in her blue silk gown. The Pinewood String Quartet played the *Frostwood Waltz* three times.

Gus finished his scarf. It was one hundred and twenty-five feet long, one foot for every year, and they wrapped it all the way round the lodge like a ribbon on a present.

Nobody was in any hurry to leave.



THE END

THANK YOU

A NOTE FROM FROSTWOOD



Thank you for spending a snowbound week at the Frostwood Lodge. If you enjoyed solving these cases, a short review helps other puzzlers find the book, and Mr. Pemberton reads every single one (Gus reads them aloud to him).